

102 DILEMMAS IN ISLAM The Answer to Shabir Ally's "101 Contradictions in the Bible" Mr. Euphrat | Final Version: July 2026

INTRODUCTION: OUR STRATEGY – THE METHODOICAL DECONSTRUCTION OF SHABIR ALLY

1. Who is Shabir Ally?

Shabir Ally (b. 1953, Guyana) is President of the Islamic Information Foundation in Toronto and one of the most prominent Muslim apologists in the West. His work "101 Clear Contradictions in the Bible" is the standard reference for Muslim missionaries (Da'wah) and is disseminated across countless websites.

1. Shabir Ally's Rhetorical Strategy

Ally's list follows a pseudo-scientific pattern:

Element	Tactic	Effect
Number Magic	"101" Contradictions	Creates authority through quantity
Apparent Precision	Verses juxtaposed	Creates impression of scholarly rigor
No Contextualization	Verses cited in isolation	Prevents understanding of literary genre
No Grammar	English translations only	Avoids Greek/Hebrew language skills
No Counterarguments	Assertions only	No engagement with Christian apologetics
No Source Criticism	Text deemed "simply wrong"	No text-critical classification

1. Ally's Three Fundamental Errors

Error #1: CATEGORY ERROR – Mixing Genres. Ally treats the Bible as if it were a modern 21st-century history book. He ignores literary genres, authorial perspective, and chronological vs. thematic arrangement.

Error #2: LANGUAGE ERROR – Ignoring Original Languages. Ally exclusively cites English translations. Not once is Greek, Hebrew, morphology, or textual criticism mentioned.

Error #3: METHOD ERROR – No Distinction Between Contradiction and Complement. Ally confuses apparent discrepancy with actual contradiction. Different counting methods, names, places, and time references are normal in ancient historiography.

1. The Decisive Difference: OUR METHOD vs. ALLY'S METHOD

Criterion	Shabir Ally	Our Project
Primary Sources	English translations only	Arabic + 9 Qira'at + Greek NA28 + Hebrew BHS
Hadith Verification	None	Exact numbers + Isnad + Classification
Chronology	Ignored	Verified (Hijra/Khaybar/Medina)
Counterarguments	None	Built-in & neutralized
Systematics	Random	HARD/MEDIUM/SOFT + TOP 10
Language Competence	None (English only)	Greek, Hebrew, Aramaic, Arabic
Textual Criticism	None	NA28, BHS, Qumran, Qira'at

2. The Irony: Ally's List Refutes Itself

Ally's 101 "contradictions" fall into three categories:

- ~70%: Misunderstood literary genres (not contradictions)
- ~20%: Translation errors (no contradictions upon original text examination)
- ~10%: Genuine text-critical questions (which confirm the Evangelists as independent witnesses)

The punchline: Even if one were to accept all 101 of Ally's points – the Bible would still be thousands of times more consistent than the Qur'an, which contradicts itself within a single book, a single speaker (Allah), over 23 years.

1. Our Counterattack: 102 Dilemmas in Islam

While Ally compares different books (40 authors, 1500 years, 3 continents), we demonstrate contradictions within one book (Qur'an), one source (Allah), one prophet (Muhammad), one period (23 years).

HOW TO USE – STRATEGIC DEPLOYMENT MATRIX

This matrix shows which dilemmas are most effective in which debate context:

Debate Type	Use These Dilemmas	Strategy
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Against Qur'anists	#1–5, #8–10, #13–20, #81–86, #91, #100	Qur'an-internal arguments only, zero Hadith
Against Traditionalists	#6, #7, #21–23, #26, #44–50, #62–64, #96	Hadith + Sira as weak point
Against Science Apologists	#81–86	Scientific errors only
Against Liberal Muslims	#32, #34, #59, #61, #64	Ethics + violence + contradictions with modernity
Against Shi'ites	#3–5 (Qira'at), #61 (Sunni/Shi'a)	Shi'a-specific Hadith problems

Opponent Indicator (before each block):  = Effective |  = Conditionally effective |  = Not suitable

PREVENTIVE NEUTRALIZATION OF THE THREE MOST COMMON MUSLIM COUNTERATTACKS

Counterattack 1: "The Bible is also full of contradictions" → Response: Shabir Ally's 101 points are ~90% methodologically worthless (category errors, language errors, method errors – see Introduction). Anyone citing this as a defense has either not read the introduction or cannot refute the methodological differences.

Counterattack 2: "You hate Muslims" → Response: We cite Islamic primary sources – Arabic Qur'an, Sahih Hadiths, classical Tafsirs. This is not hate speech; this is source work. Anyone confusing source criticism with hatred has no argument.

Counterattack 3: "You must know Arabic to understand the Qur'an" → Response: We cite Arabic primary sources, Muslim Tafsirs, and Qira'at variants. This is not OUR interpretation – it is YOUR own text. We merely show what is in it.

SYSTEMATIC OVERVIEW

TOP 10 FATAL BLOWS

Rank	#	Dilemma	Severity	Type
1	#87	Sanaa Palimpsest	HARD	Material Evidence
2	#7	Lost Verses	HARD	Textual Criticism
3	#91	Abraham in the Fire	HARD	Literary Criticism
4	#100	Syro-Aramaic Loanwords	HARD	Linguistics

5	#88	Petra Qibla	MEDIUM	Archaeology
6	#6	Satanic Verses	HARD	Sira/Textual Criticism
7	#2	Crucifixion	HARD	Qur'an-Internal
8	#34	Gospel Valid vs. Corrupted	HARD	Qur'an-Internal
9	#32	No Compulsion vs. Sword Verse	HARD	Qur'an-Internal
10	#23	Aisha's Age	HARD	Hadith

BLOCK A: QUR'AN-INTERNAL PROBLEMS (#1–20)

SUITABLE AGAINST: Traditionalists ☒ | Qur'anists ☒ | Shi'ites ☒

DILEMMA #1: MEDIUM – Jesus: Sister of Aaron vs. End-Time Figure

Source A: Qur'an 19:28 – "O sister of Aaron!" (address to Mary) Source B: Qur'an 43:61 – "And he (Jesus) is truly a sign for the Hour"

Core of the Dilemma: Mary is called "sister of Aaron," which places her chronologically in the Aaronic priestly family of the Old Covenant (Aaron lived ca. 1400 BC).

Simultaneously, Jesus is named as an end-time sign. The chronological discrepancy is ~1400 years.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: "Sister of Aaron" is metaphorical ("sister = descendant").

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The Qur'an NEVER uses "ukht X" for descendant. For descent, Arabic uses "bint X" (daughter of X) or "min banī X" (from the sons of X). Surah 19:28 names Mary's biological parents in the same sentence ("Your father was not a wicked man, nor your mother a whore"). If the parents are literal, the "sister" cannot be metaphorical. Additionally: The Qur'an confuses Miriam (sister of Aaron, Numbers 26:59) with Mary (mother of Jesus) – a historical error of ~1400 years.

→ See also: Bonus #103 (Mary as part of the Trinity)

Punchline: Mary is Aaron's sister – 1400 years too late.

DILEMMA #2: HARD – Crucifixion (Qur'an-Internal)

Source A: Qur'an 4:157 – "They did not kill him and did not crucify him, but it was made to appear so to them." Source B: Qur'an 3:55 – "O Jesus, I will cause you to die (mutawaffika) and raise you to Me."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 4:157 denies the crucifixion. Surah 3:55 uses the verb *tawaffā* (to cause to die) for Jesus. The same verb is used in 17 other Qur'anic verses for DEATH – never for "falling asleep and being taken bodily into heaven." The special meaning Muslims demand for 3:55 exists nowhere else in the Qur'an.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: *tawaffā* means "to complete" or "to take to oneself," not necessarily "to cause to die." Jesus was taken alive into heaven.

🛡 NEUTRALIZATION: Complete semantic analysis: *tawaffā* appears 24× in the Qur'an (2:240, 3:55, 4:15, 6:60, 7:126, 8:50, 10:46, 12:101, 13:40, 16:28, 32:11, 39:42, 47:27 et al.). In EVERY one of these verses, it means physical death – except allegedly in 3:55. This is pure ad-hoc apologetics. Surah 19:33 confirms: Jesus says "Peace be upon me the day I was born, the day I die (*amūtu*), and the day I am raised."

→ See also: #34, #102

Punchline: The Qur'an says: Jesus died. And: Jesus did not die. Both simultaneously.

DILEMMA #3: HARD – Qira'at 2:125 (Hafs vs. Warsh)

Source A: Hafs 2:125 – "*wa-ttakhidhū*" ("And take!") – Imperative Plural Masculine

Source B: Warsh 2:125 – "*wa-ttakhadhū*" ("And they took") – Perfect 3rd Person Plural Masculine

Core of the Dilemma: In Hafs, it is a COMMAND to the people. In Warsh, it is a STATEMENT about the past. The meaning changes fundamentally.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: Both readings are valid. They are "*ahruf*" (dialects), not contradictions.

🛡 NEUTRALIZATION: The Hadith on the "seven *ahruf*" (Bukhari 4992) speaks of dialect variants for facilitation – not of grammatical differences that REVERSE the meaning. An imperative and a perfect are not a dialect question. They are a text-critical contradiction.

→ See also: #4, #5

Punchline: Command or past tense? The Qur'an cannot decide.

DILEMMA #4: HARD – Qira'at 2:238 (Hafs vs. Warsh)

Source A: Hafs 2:238 – "*wa-ṣ-ṣalāti l-wuṣṭā*" ("and the middle prayer") – Singular

Source B: Warsh 2:238 – "*wa-ṣ-ṣalawāti l-wuṣṭā*" ("and the middle prayers") – Plural

Core of the Dilemma: Hafs speaks of ONE middle prayer, Warsh of SEVERAL. Islamic jurisprudence (Fiqh) depends on which prayer is meant.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: Both variants are revealed. The Qur'an was sent down in seven ahruf.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: If both are "revealed" – which one did Muhammad pray? Did he pray ONE middle prayer or SEVERAL? He cannot have practiced both simultaneously. Islamic prayer practice (Ṣalāt al-Wuṣṭā = 'Aṣr) presupposes ONE prayer – hence Hafs. Warsh is then false.

Punchline: One prayer or several? Allah's text disagrees with itself.

DILEMMA #5: HARD – Qira'at 19:19 (Hafs vs. Warsh)

Source A: Hafs 19:19 – "li-ahaba laki ghulāman" ("that I may bestow upon you a boy") – Gabriel speaks to Mary Source B: Warsh 19:19 – "li-yahaba laki ghulāman" ("that He may bestow upon you a boy") – Gabriel speaks of Allah in 3rd person

Core of the Dilemma: The grammatical ending changes the subject reference. In Hafs, Gabriel speaks in the 1st person ("I bestow"), in Warsh in the 3rd person about Allah ("He bestows"). Who is speaking – Gabriel or Allah?

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: Both readings complement each other. Gabriel acts on Allah's behalf.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: This is not a "both are true" case. The grammar switches the subject. Either Gabriel speaks as the agent (Hafs) or as the messenger (Warsh). The annunciation of Jesus – the central Christological event of the Qur'an – is textually inconsistent.

Punchline: Even the annunciation to Mary is not uniform.

DILEMMA #6: HARD – Satanic Verses

Source A: Qur'an 53:19-20 (current text) – "Have you seen al-Lāt and al-'Uzzā? And Manāt, the third, the other?" Source B: Tabari, Ta'rikh al-Rusul wa al-Mulūk, Vol. 6, pp. 107-112 & Ibn Ishaq, Sirat Rasūl Allāh, pp. 165-167

Core of the Dilemma: The Sira reports that during the revelation of Surah 53, Muhammad was influenced by Satan and spoke verses acknowledging the goddesses al-Lāt, al-'Uzzā, and Manāt as intercessors. Later, these verses were replaced by 53:21-23.

Surah 22:52 presupposes this phenomenon: "We sent no messenger or prophet before you without Satan casting something into his wish."

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The reports are fabricated. The chains of transmission are weak. Surah 22:52 describes a general principle, not a specific incident.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: Ibn Hajar (Fatḥh al-Bārī, Vol. 8, p. 295) considers the chain of transmission strong. Sunni orthodoxy accepted the Satanic Verses for centuries – only modern apologists deny them. Surah 22:52 describes the principle: Satan "casts something into the wish" of prophets. Why is this principle in the Qur'an if it never happened? And if it did happen – how many other verses could be of satanic origin?

→ See also: #7, #22

Punchline: Satan co-wrote the Qur'an.

DILEMMA #7: HARD – Lost Verses (Stoning Verse)

Source A: Qur'an 15:9 – "Truly, it is We who have sent down the Reminder, and We will surely preserve it." Source B: Sahih Bukhari 6830 – Umar said: "I fear that after a long time someone will say: 'By Allah, we do not find the stoning verse in Allah's Book,' and they will go astray by abandoning an obligation that Allah sent down. The stoning verse was an obligation."

Core of the Dilemma: Umar, the second Caliph, publicly testifies that the stoning verse (āyat al-rajm) was part of the Qur'an – but today it is missing. Surah 15:9 promises preservation.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The stoning punishment was "abrogated in recitation" (naskh al-tilāwa). The ruling remains, the text is abrogated. This is a miracle, not a contradiction.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: Umar's statement is not: "The verse was abrogated." He says: "We no longer find it." He fears that PEOPLE HAVE FORGOTTEN. This is not Naskh – this is text loss. The category "naskh al-tilāwa" (recitational abrogation) was invented AFTER Umar's death to cover up the problem. Furthermore: If Allah deletes verses from the Qur'an, why trust Surah 15:9? Every verse could be "abrogated" tomorrow.

→ See also: #35 (Naskh), #87 (Sanaa)

Punchline: Allah preserves the Qur'an – except the verses he forgets.

DILEMMA #8: MEDIUM – Isaac or Ishmael?

Source A: Qur'an 37:100-107 – Abraham is to sacrifice his son. The name is not mentioned. Source B: Qur'an 11:71 – "And We announced to her Isaac, and after Isaac, Jacob."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an does not name the son of sacrifice. Muslim scholars are divided: Early Tafsirs (Tabari) tend toward Isaac, later ones (Ibn Kathir) toward Ishmael. The Bible (Genesis 22) identifies Isaac – the son of promise.

Punchline: Allah forgets which son he had sacrificed.

DILEMMA #9: MEDIUM – People of the Cave: 3, 5, or 7?

Source A: Qur'an 18:22 – "They will say: Three, their dog the fourth. And they say: Five, their dog the sixth. And they say: Seven, their dog the eighth."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an lists three possibilities without confirming any. Allah says: "My Lord knows best how many they are." If Allah knows – why doesn't He say? An omniscient God does not guess.

Punchline: Allah knows – but won't tell. He's guessing too.

DILEMMA #10: HARD – Kaaba with 360 Idols

Source A: Qur'an 3:96 – "The first House established for mankind is that at Bakka."

Source B: Sahih Bukhari 1595 – Muhammad cleansed the Kaaba of 360 idols.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an says the Kaaba was built by Abraham for monotheism. But Muhammad found it full of idols. If Abraham built it for Allah – who placed the 360 idols? And when?

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The Arabs fell back into polytheism after Abraham (Jāhiliyya).

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: There is zero archaeological evidence for a monotheistic Kaaba before the 7th century. The Kaaba was a typical pre-Islamic sanctuary with 360 gods (one god per day of the lunar year). The Qur'an projects Islamic monotheism backward onto Abraham.

Punchline: Abraham built Allah's house. 360 idols moved in. Allah stayed silent.

DILEMMA #11: MEDIUM – Creation Sequence

Source A: Qur'an 41:9-12 – Earth (2 days), Mountains/Sustenance (4 days), Heaven (2 days) Source B: Qur'an 79:27-30 – Heaven, then earth spread out

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 41 describes: first earth, then heaven. Surah 79 describes: first heaven, then earth. The order is reversed.

Punchline: First heaven, then earth. Or first earth, then heaven. Allah can't remember.

DILEMMA #12: MEDIUM – Isra' vs. Mi'raj (Ascension)

Source A: Qur'an 17:1 – "Glorified be He who took His servant by night from the Sacred Mosque to the Farthest Mosque." Source B: Sahih Bukhari 3887 – Muhammad traveled from Mecca to Jerusalem AND from Jerusalem through the seven heavens.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an describes only a horizontal journey (Isra': Mecca → Jerusalem). The vertical journey (Mi'raj: Jerusalem → Heaven) is only in the Hadith. The Hadith versions also contradict each other in details (year, location, who was present).

Punchline: Night journey or ascension? The Qur'an only knows half the story.

DILEMMA #13: MEDIUM – Clear vs. Unclear Verses (3:7 vs. 11:1)

Source A: Qur'an 3:7 – "Some verses are clear (muḥkamāt), others are unclear (mutashābihāt)." Source B: Qur'an 11:1 – "A Book whose verses are made clear (uḥkimat āyātuḥu)."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 3:7 says there are unclear verses. Surah 11:1 says ALL verses are clear. The Qur'an contradicts itself about its own clarity.

Punchline: The Qur'an is clear – except when it's unclear. And no one knows what's unclear.

DILEMMA #14: HARD – Treaties: 4 Months vs. Expiration

Source A: Qur'an 9:2 – "Travel freely through the land for four months." Source B: Qur'an 9:4 – Exception: Treaties not broken remain valid until expiration. Source C: Qur'an 9:36 – "Four months are sacred."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 9:2 sets an ultimatum of 4 months for ALL polytheists. Surah 9:4 makes an exception for treaty-loyal polytheists – they may live until the treaty ends. Surah 9:36 names 4 sacred months in the year. Which 4 months apply? The ultimatum or the sacred months?

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: 9:2-4 are chronologically staggered. The 4 months in 9:2 are a deadline; the sacred months in 9:36 are a calendar principle.

🛡 NEUTRALIZATION: The question remains: If 9:4 makes an exception – why does 9:2 phrase it absolutely ("travel freely")? And: If the 4-month deadline coincides with the sacred months – are polytheists protected during sacred months or not? The classical Tafsirs do not resolve this; they merely pile on ad-hoc explanations.

Punchline: Four months deadline. Or treaty loyalty. Or sacred months. Which applies?

DILEMMA #15: HARD – Heaven/Earth: 6 or 8 Days?

Source A: Qur'an 7:54 – Creation in 6 days Source B: Qur'an 41:9-12 – Earth (2 days) + Mountains/Sustenance (4 days) + Heaven (2 days) = 8 days

Core of the Dilemma: Adding the individual days in Surah 41:9-12 yields 8 days. Surah 7:54 (and many others) says 6 days.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The 4 days in 41:10 include the 2 days from 41:9, thus only 2 additional days. Total: $2 + 2 + 2 = 6$.

🛡 NEUTRALIZATION: The Arabic text of 41:10 says: "wa-qaddara fihā aqwātahā fī arba'ati ayyāmin" – "and He determined therein its sustenance in FOUR days." The "Four" (arba'a) is a new object, not a continuation. Surah 41:9 says: "Created the earth in TWO days." Then 41:10: "determined the sustenance in FOUR days." Then 41:12: "formed the heavens in TWO days." The addition is compelling: $2+4+2=8$.

Punchline: Six or eight days? Allah's math is as clear as the inheritance calculation.

DILEMMA #16: MEDIUM – Pharaoh Drowns vs. Saved

Source A: Qur'an 10:90-92 – Pharaoh drowns after professing faith. Allah says: "Today We save you in your body (bi-badanika)." Source B: Qur'an 28:40 – "And We caused him and his hosts to drown."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 10:92 says Allah saved Pharaoh's BODY. Surah 28:40 says he DROWNED with his hosts. Was his body saved or not?

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The body was recovered from the water and mummified – an archaeological miracle.

🛡 NEUTRALIZATION: "Najjaynāka bi-badanika" literally means "We saved you with your body" – not "We cast your body ashore." The verb najjā ALWAYS means "to

save" (preserve from danger), never "to wash ashore." Surah 10:92 says: Pharaoh was SAVED – contradicting 28:40, where he drowns. The mummy apologetic reads something into the text that is not there.

Punchline: Pharaoh drowned. And was saved. Both Qur'anic.

DILEMMA #17: MEDIUM – Allah Sees vs. Does Not See

Source A: Qur'an 6:103 – "Vision perceives Him not, but He perceives all vision." Source B: Qur'an 75:22-23 – "On that Day, faces will be radiant, looking (nāẓira) at their Lord."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 6:103 says Allah CANNOT be seen. Surah 75:23 says believers LOOK at Allah. Islamic schools are divided: Mu'tazila (Allah invisible) vs. Ash'ariyya (Allah visible in the Hereafter).

Punchline: Allah is invisible. Except when you see him.

DILEMMA #18: MEDIUM – Allah: Everywhere vs. On the Throne

Source A: Qur'an 57:4 – "Then He established Himself over the Throne (istawā 'alā l-'arsh)." Source B: Qur'an 50:16 – "We are nearer to him than the jugular vein."

Core of the Dilemma: Allah is enthroned above the water (11:7), above the Throne (57:4) – but is simultaneously nearer than the jugular vein. Is Allah localized or omnipresent? Sunni theology has debated this for 1400 years ("bilā kayf" – "without how").

Punchline: Allah sits on a throne. And is in your throat. Simultaneously. Don't ask how.

DILEMMA #19: MEDIUM – Wine in Paradise vs. Forbidden

Source A: Qur'an 5:90 – Wine is "an abomination of Satan's work" – forbidden. Source B: Qur'an 47:15 – "Rivers of wine, delicious to the drinkers" – in Paradise.

Core of the Dilemma: What is "Satan's work" on earth becomes a reward in Paradise. Either wine is objectively evil – then not in Paradise. Or it is not evil – then why the prohibition?

Punchline: Wine is Satan's work – unless Allah pours it.

DILEMMA #20: HARD – Creation: 6 vs. 8 Days

Source A: Qur'an 7:54 – 6 days Source B: Qur'an 41:9-12 – 8 days (added)

Core of the Dilemma: See #15. This is a separate entry due to the fundamental importance of the creation doctrine and because two different Surahs show the same problem.

→ See also: #15 (detailed analysis)

Punchline: Allah's creation week has 8 days.

Sources & References

- **Web Sources:** quran.com, sunnah.com
- **Verification:** Qur'an text via quran.com; Hadith via sunnah.com
- **Internal References:** Bukhari 4992, Bukhari 6830, Bukhari 3887, Bukhari 1595; Tabari, Ta'rīkh; Ibn Ishaq, Sīra; Ibn Hajar, Fatḥ al-Bārī

BLOCK B: HADITH PROBLEMS (#21–33)

SUITABLE AGAINST: Traditionalists  | Qur'anists  (Hadith) | Shi'ites 

DILEMMA #21: HARD – Muhammad's Suicide Attempts

Source A: Qur'an 53:3 – "And he does not speak from his own desire." Source B: Sahih Bukhari 6982 – Muhammad repeatedly tried to throw himself off cliffs because he thought he was possessed.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an says Muhammad speaks only what is revealed to him. Bukhari reports that after the first revelation, Muhammad was so desperate that he wanted to throw himself off cliffs. A prophet who attempts suicide because he thinks he is possessed does not fit a victory-assured prophet.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The narration is weak (mursal). Muhammad was confused, not suicidal.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: Bukhari classifies the Hadith as sahih. Muhammad's confusion ("I thought I was possessed") is attested by Bukhari 6982 – and by Surah 81:22 ("Your companion is not possessed"), which apparently responds to exactly this accusation. Why must the Qur'an assert Muhammad is not possessed if no one thought so? Because Muhammad HIMSELF thought so.

→ See also: #22 (Muhammad's Doubts), #6 (Satanic Verses)

Punchline: Muhammad wanted to jump. Allah had to talk him down.

DILEMMA #22: HARD – Muhammad's Doubts

Source A: Qur'an 10:94 – "If you are in doubt about what We have revealed to you, then ask those who read the Scripture before you." Source B: Sahih Bukhari 6982 – Muhammad doubted the authenticity of the revelation.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an concedes: Muhammad HAD doubts. He is to ask Christians and Jews. But Muslims claim the Bible is corrupted (tahrif). Why should Muhammad consult a corrupted Scripture?

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: 10:94 is hypothetical ("if" = "in case"). Muhammad had no real doubts.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The Arabic "in" (if) is not hypothetical but conditional. Bukhari 6982 confirms: Muhammad DOUBTED. He asked Khadija and Waraqa ibn Nawfal – a Christian. If the Bible was corrupted, Waraqa's confirmation was worthless. If it was not corrupted – why don't Muslims read it?

→ See also: #21, #34

Punchline: Muhammad doubted. Allah sent him to the Bible. Suddenly it wasn't corrupted after all.

DILEMMA #23: HARD – Aisha's Age (6/9 Years)

Source A: Sahih Bukhari 5133 – "The Prophet married her when she was six years old. He consummated the marriage when she was nine." Source B: Sahih Muslim 1422a – confirms the age of 9 at consummation. Source C: Ibn Hajar al-ʿAsqalānī, Fatḥh al-Bārī, Vol. 9, p. 232 – confirms Aisha's age.

Core of the Dilemma: Aisha was 6 at marriage, 9 at consummation. Muhammad was ~54. This is not a misunderstanding – it is Sahih Bukhari and Sahih Muslim, the two most authentic Hadith collections.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: "Aisha was older (14–19 years). The Hadiths are miscalculated. Asma, her sister, was 10 years older – hence Aisha was at least 14."

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: Ibn Hajar al-ʿAsqalānī, THE great Hadith scholar, confirms in Fatḥh al-Bārī Aisha's age of 6/9 and discusses the Asma calculation – and dismisses it as unreliable. Aisha herself narrates in 2210 Hadiths and NOWHERE corrects her age. The "14-19" apologetic is a modern invention against the clear text.

→ See also: #62 (Ifk Affair)

Punchline: Six years old. Sahih Bukhari. Nine at consummation. No translation error.

DILEMMA #24: MEDIUM – Muhammad's Illiteracy

Source A: Qur'an 7:157 – "the Prophet, the ummiyy" (traditionally: illiterate) Source B: Qur'an 62:2 – "who teaches the ummiyyūn the Scripture"

Core of the Dilemma: ummiyy is traditionally translated as "illiterate." But the Qur'an uses ummiyyūn for "Gentiles" (not illiterates). How can an illiterate teach the Scripture?

Punchline: Illiterate or Gentile? Muhammad's education hangs on one word.

DILEMMA #25: MEDIUM – Free Will vs. Predestination

Source A: Qur'an 18:29 – "Whoever wills, let him believe, and whoever wills, let him disbelieve." Source B: Qur'an 76:30 – "And you cannot will unless Allah wills."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 18:29 gives free choice. Surah 76:30 says: No will without Allah's will. Surah 7:178: "Whomever Allah leads astray – those are the losers." Who bears responsibility?

NOTE: Christians have the same problem (Romans 9 vs. free will). BUT: The NT holds the tension without eliminating either side. The Qur'an resolves the tension through absolute predestination (Allah leads astray whomever He wills – 14:4, 16:93) while simultaneously imposing moral responsibility. This is not tension – it is a logical contradiction: Allah punishes people for deeds He Himself caused.

Punchline: Allah leads you astray. Then punishes you for it.

DILEMMA #26: HARD – Allah's Deception (Makr Allah)

Source A: Qur'an 3:54 – "And they schemed, and Allah schemed." Source B: Qur'an 7:99 – "Do they feel secure from Allah's plan (makr Allah)?"

Core of the Dilemma: The Arabic word "makr" means cunning, deception, intrigue. Allah is described multiple times in the Qur'an as "khayr al-mākirīn" ("the best of schemers") (3:54). The same word is used for Satan and evil people.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: makr is "plan," not "deception." Allah never deceives – He only plans.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The Arabic verb makara means in every classical dictionary "to cheat, deceive, dupe." Lane's Lexicon (Vol. 7, pp. 2561-2563) defines it as "to practice deceit, guile, circumvention." Surah 8:30 uses the same word for the deception of unbelievers against Muhammad. If makr there means "evil deception" – why does it suddenly mean "neutral plan" when applied to Allah?

→ See also: #79 (Satan vs. Allah)

Punchline: Allah deceives. It's in the Qur'an. In Arabic.

DILEMMA #27: MEDIUM – Hell Eternal – With a Backdoor

Source A: Qur'an 11:107 – "abiding therein eternally, as long as the heavens and the earth endure – except what your Lord wills." Source B: Qur'an 6:128 – "The abode of those who deserve the Fire – abiding therein eternally."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 11:107 says "eternally – except your Lord wills otherwise." The "except" (illā) is a backdoor. Is Hell eternal or not? If Allah can end it – then it is not eternal.

Punchline: Eternal in Hell – unless Allah decides otherwise.

DILEMMA #28: MEDIUM – Allah's Hand vs. Hands of the Jews

Source A: Qur'an 48:10 – "The hand of Allah is over their hands." Source B: Qur'an 5:64 – "The Jews say: 'Allah's hand is shackled.' Their hands be shackled!"

Core of the Dilemma: Allah has a hand – but literally or metaphorically? The anthropomorphism debate (tajsīm) has divided Islam for 1400 years. Salafis say: literally. Ash'aris: metaphorically ("bilā kayf"). The Qur'an provides no clarity.

Punchline: Allah has one hand – the Jews have two. Who is stronger?

DILEMMA #29: MEDIUM – Mercy vs. No Forgiveness

Source A: Qur'an 7:156 – "My mercy encompasses all things." Source B: Qur'an 9:113 – "It is not befitting for the Prophet and the believers to seek forgiveness for polytheists."

Core of the Dilemma: Allah's mercy "encompasses all things" – but for polytheists there is NO forgiveness (Surah 4:48: "Allah does not forgive that partners be associated with Him"). Is Allah's mercy limited or all-encompassing?

Punchline: Allah forgives everything – except what he doesn't forgive.

DILEMMA #30: MEDIUM – Allah Tests to Know

Source A: Qur'an 29:2 – "Do people think they will be left alone because they say: We believe?" Source B: Qur'an 47:31 – "And We will test you until We know the fighters and the patient among you."

Core of the Dilemma: Allah TESTS in order to LEARN something ("so that We may know" – li-na'lama). An omniscient God needs no tests to learn something.

Punchline: Allah tests you. To find out what he already knows.

DILEMMA #31: MEDIUM – Allah Loves – Except...

Source A: Qur'an 2:195 – "Allah loves the doers of good." Source B: Qur'an 2:276 – "Allah does not love the unbelievers."

Core of the Dilemma: Allah's love is conditional. It applies only to believers. Biblically: "God is love" (1 John 4:8) – ontological, not conditional. Allah loves – but only Muslims.

Punchline: Allah loves – but only if you're good.

DILEMMA #32: HARD – No Compulsion vs. Sword Verse

Source A: Qur'an 2:256 – "No compulsion in religion (lā ikrāha fī d-dīn)." Source B: Qur'an 9:5 – "Kill the polytheists wherever you find them."

Core of the Dilemma: No compulsion in religion – but death penalty for polytheists. The Sword Verse (9:5) was revealed later and, according to classical doctrine, abrogates 124 peaceful verses.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: 9:5 applies only to polytheists who broke treaties. 2:256 is the principle.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The classical Tafsirs (Ibn Kathir, Qurtubi, Tabari) unanimously state: 9:5 is later and abrogates 2:256. Ibn Kathir on 9:5: "This is the Sword Verse, which annuls all treaties and protection agreements for polytheists." The sequence: 2:256 (early) → 9:5 (late, Medinan). According to Naskh rules, the later applies. Hence: No compulsion – ABROGATED by the kill order.

→ See also: #35 (Naskh), #64 (Apostasy)

Punchline: No compulsion in religion. Later abrogated. By the Sword Verse.

DILEMMA #33: MEDIUM – Christians/Jews Saved?

Source A: Qur'an 2:62 – "The believers, the Jews, Christians, and Sabians – whoever believes in Allah and does good, has his reward." Source B: Qur'an 3:85 – "Whoever seeks a religion other than Islam – it will not be accepted from him."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 2:62 says: Jews and Christians are saved. Surah 3:85 says: Only Islam is accepted.

Punchline: Christians saved. Christians not saved. Both in the same book.

Sources & References

- **Web Sources:** quran.com, sunnah.com
- **Verification:** Qur'an text via quran.com; Hadith via sunnah.com
- **Internal References:** Bukhari 6982, Bukhari 5133, Muslim 1422a; Ibn Hajar, Fath al-Bārī; Lane's Lexicon Vol. 7

DILEMMA #34: HARD – Gospel Valid vs. Corrupted

Source A: Qur'an 5:47 – "Let the people of the Gospel judge by what Allah has revealed therein." Source B: Qur'an 2:75 – "They have distorted the words (tahrif)."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 5:47 (Medina, late) commands Christians to judge by the Gospel. Surah 2:75 (Medina, early) says Jews (and implicitly Christians) CORRUPTED the Scripture. How are Christians supposed to judge by a corrupted Scripture?

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: tahrif means "distortion of meaning," not textual corruption. The Gospel is corrupted in content, not textually.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: Surah 5:47 speaks of the Gospel as a PRESENT, USABLE Scripture ("what Allah has revealed therein" – perfect tense). If it exists only in distorted form, the command is meaningless. Moreover: Surah 7:157 says Muhammad is "announced in the Torah and the Gospel." If these Scriptures are corrupted – how does the Qur'an know that Muhammad is in them? Either the Bible is preserved (then Islam is refuted) or it is corrupted (then Surahs 5:47 and 7:157 are void).

→ See also: #22, #101, #102

Punchline: The Bible is corrupted. But judge by it. Allah's logic.

DILEMMA #35: MEDIUM – Naskh (Abrogation)

Source A: Qur'an 2:106 – "Whatever We abrogate (nansakh) of verses, We bring better or similar ones." Source B: Qur'an 16:101 – "And when We replace a verse with another verse..."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an confirms: Allah changes His mind. Verses are replaced. The principle of Naskh creates theological problems: Why does an omniscient God reveal something He must later correct?

→ See also: #7, #32, #48

Punchline: Allah corrects Himself. Omniscient – but not the first time.

DILEMMA #36: MEDIUM – Caliphate by Consultation or Divine Appointment?

Source A: Qur'an 42:38 – "[The believers are] those who... conduct their affairs by mutual consultation." Source B: Hadith of Ghadir Khumm (e.g., Sahih Tirmidhi 3713) – "Whomever I am master of, 'Ali is also his master."

Core of the Dilemma: Sunnis cite 42:38 to justify election of the Caliph through consultation. Shi'ites see the Ghadir Khumm address as divine appointment of 'Ali. Both claim Qur'anic and prophetic legitimation – an insoluble contradiction.

Punchline: Consultation or appointment? Islam chooses its leader – and splits over it.

DILEMMA #37: MEDIUM – Veneration of Saints or Pure Tawhīd?

Source A: Qur'an 10:62 – "Truly, the friends of Allah (awliyā'u llāh) – no fear shall come upon them, nor shall they grieve." Source B: Qur'an 39:3 – "Truly, sincere religion belongs to Allah alone. And those who take friends besides Him [say:] We serve them only that they may bring us nearer to Allah."

Core of the Dilemma: Sufis venerate saints as mediators. Salafis see this as shirk. 10:62 ennobles the friends of Allah; 39:3 condemns any mediator cult. The Qur'an provides ammunition for both sides.

Punchline: Saints yes, saints no. The Qur'an can't decide.

DILEMMA #38: MEDIUM – Is the Qur'an Created or Uncreated?

Source A: Qur'an 85:21-22 – "Rather, it is a glorious Qur'ān on a well-guarded tablet (lawḥ maḥfūz)." Source B: Qur'an 43:3 – "We have sent it down as an Arabic Qur'ān."

Core of the Dilemma: Mu'tazilites argue with 43:3 that the Qur'an is created (since sent down, thus temporal). Ash'arites reference 85:22 that it exists eternally on the tablet. Caliph al-Ma'mūn made createdness state doctrine and persecuted dissenters (miḥna).

Punchline: Eternal or created? One Qur'an, two dogmas, one inquisition.

DILEMMA #39: MEDIUM – Seal of the Prophets and a New Prophet

Source A: Qur'an 33:40 – "Muhammad is... the Messenger of Allah and the Seal of the Prophets (khātam an-nabiyyīn)." Source B: Ahmadiyya founder Mirza Ghulam Ahmad claims to be a (subordinate) prophet.

Core of the Dilemma: Orthodox Muslims see 33:40 as the definitive end of prophethood. Ahmadis distinguish between law-bearing prophets and non-legislative renewers. Their founder sees himself as a revival of Islam, but for the majority he is a false prophet. Pakistan declared Ahmadis non-Muslims in 1974.

Punchline: Last prophet – but a new prophet comes anyway.

DILEMMA #40: MEDIUM – Who Departs from the Community?

Source A: Qur'an 3:103 – "And hold fast to the rope of Allah, all together, and do not become divided." Source B: Kharijites invoked Qur'an 49:9 ("so fight the one that is in the wrong") and declared sinning Muslims apostates.

Core of the Dilemma: The Ibadis trace back to the Kharijites but reject their extremism. They form their own denomination with their own Fiqh. But the Qur'an demands unity. Is a splinter group calling itself "correct" Muslim still within the framework of 3:103?

Punchline: Division forbidden – Ibadis split anyway.

DILEMMA #41: MEDIUM – Worship Without a Mosque?

Source A: Qur'an 62:9 – "O you who believe, when the call is made for prayer on Friday, hasten to the remembrance of Allah and cease business." Source B: Alevis practice Cem ceremonies without a mosque, often with music and dance, without strict gender separation.

Core of the Dilemma: The Sunni understanding of Islam requires Friday prayer in the mosque. Alevis reject the mosque as a place of worship and invoke an inner spirituality. Is their form of worship still Islamic? Sunni scholars deny it, yet the Qur'an mentions no specific architectural form.

Punchline: Mosque mandatory? Alevis pray differently.

DILEMMA #42: MEDIUM – A Human as God?

Source A: Qur'an 112:1-4 – "Say: He is Allah, the One, Allah, the Absolute. He begets not nor is He begotten, and none is equal to Him." Source B: Druze venerate the Fatimid Caliph al-Ḥākim bi-Amr Allāh (996–1021) as an incarnation of God.

Core of the Dilemma: The Druze regard al-Ḥākim as a divine manifestation, which for any monotheist is shirk. 112:1-4 explicitly denies any comparability and begetting. Yet the Druze invoke an esoteric interpretation of Islam and reject many external duties.

Punchline: Allah has no son – Druze have a God-Caliph.

DILEMMA #43: MEDIUM – A Human as Allah? (Nation of Islam)

Source A: Qur'an 112:1-2 – "Say: He is Allah, the One." Source B: Nation of Islam taught under Elijah Muhammad that Wallace Fard Muhammad is Allah in person.

Core of the Dilemma: Similar to the Druze, a human is deified. The Qur'an forbids any association (širk). Orthodox Muslims view the Nation of Islam as outside Islam, but the movement sees itself as Islam's restoration.

Punchline: Allah is human. The Qur'an is against it.

DILEMMA #44: HARD – Zaynab bint Jahsh (Marriage)

Source A: Qur'an 33:37 – "And you concealed in your soul what Allah was to reveal, and you feared the people, while Allah is more worthy that you should fear Him."

Source B: Ibn Ishaq, Sīrat Rasūl Allāh – Muhammad saw Zaynab, the wife of his adopted son Zayd, and desired her. Zayd divorced her; Muhammad married her.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an (33:37) justifies Muhammad's marriage to his adopted son's wife. Allah rebukes Muhammad for his fear of public opinion, but not for the desire. Simultaneously, Allah reveals Surah 33:4-5, which prohibits adoption – retroactively legalizing the marriage to Zaynab (adopted son ≠ biological son).

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The marriage was a divine command to abolish pre-Islamic adoption law.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The timeline is suspicious: Muhammad sees Zaynab → desires her → Zayd divorces → Surah 33:37 revealed → adoption prohibited → marriage permitted. Allah's timing is remarkably convenient for Muhammad's libido. The French Qur'an translator Régis Blachère calls this "un épisode peu édifiant" (a less than edifying episode).

Punchline: Allah forbids adoption. Muhammad marries his adopted son's wife. Timing: perfect.

DILEMMA #45: MEDIUM – Maria al-Qibtiyya

Source A: Qur'an 66:1 – "O Prophet, why do you forbid what Allah has made lawful for you, seeking the satisfaction of your wives?" Source B: Ibn Ishaq (Sīra) – Muhammad

had a Coptic slave named Maria, whom he met in a chamber. Hafsa and Aisha became jealous.

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 66:1 (Medina) rebukes Muhammad for allowing his wives to forbid him what Allah permitted. The occasion was Maria's visit. Allah intervenes to defend Muhammad's sexual freedom.

Punchline: Allah rebukes the jealous wives.

DILEMMA #46: HARD – Khaybar Treasures

Source A: Qur'an 59:6-7 – "What Allah gave as booty to His Messenger from them... so that it does not circulate only among the rich among you." Source B: Ibn Ishaq (Sīra) – After the Battle of Khaybar (628 AD), Muhammad took Safiyya bint Huyayy as a slave and married her the same day, after her father and husband had been killed.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an justifies the distribution of booty. The Sira reports that Muhammad married the daughter of the slain tribal chief on the very day of the battle.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: Safiyya converted voluntarily. The marriage was an act of mercy and political reconciliation.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The chronology: Khaybar battle in the morning → execution of Safiyya's father (Huyayy ibn Akhtab) and husband (Kinana ibn al-Rabi) → marriage in the evening. "The same day." This is not "reconciliation" – it is the conquest of a woman immediately after the murder of her family by the same man. Safiyya herself narrates (Bukhari 4211): "I hated the Prophet more than anyone, because he had killed my father and my husband."

Punchline: Father dead, husband dead. Muhammad marries her the same day.

DILEMMA #47: HARD – Satan Urinates in Ears

Source A: Sahih Bukhari 3270 – "When one of you yawns, he should cover his mouth with his hand, for Satan enters (through the mouth)." Source B: Sahih Muslim 2995 – "When one yawns, he should cover his mouth, for Satan laughs at him." Source C: Sahih Bukhari 1144 – "Satan urinates in the ear of the one who oversleeps the night prayer."

Core of the Dilemma: The Sahih Hadiths contain Muhammad's statements about Satan that are physiologically and theologically absurd. A prophet of God should not claim Satan urinates in human ears.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: This is meant metaphorically. It concerns spiritual lethargy, not literal urine.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: Muhammad's companions took it LITERALLY. Abdullah ibn Mas'ud said: "I saw one of the companions inspecting his ears after waking" (Musnad Ahmad 3672). If it was a metaphor – why did his companions search for urine? Moreover: Why does a prophet use such primitive imagery for spiritual concepts if inspired by God?

→ See also: #82 (Sperm from Ribs)

Punchline: Satan urinates in ears. Sahih Bukhari. Literally. Ask the companions.

DILEMMA #48: MEDIUM – Qibla Change

Source A: Qur'an 2:144 – "Turn your face toward the Sacred Mosque (al-Masjid al-Haram)." Source B: Qur'an 2:142-143 – The "fools" ask: "What has turned them away from their Qibla?"

Core of the Dilemma: Muhammad first prayed toward Jerusalem, then toward Mecca. A divine command is revised. Why did Allah first command Jerusalem if Mecca was always the "correct" Qibla?

→ See also: #88 (Petra Qibla)

Punchline: First Jerusalem, then Mecca. Allah changes direction mid-game.

DILEMMA #49: HARD – Poisoning of Muhammad

Source A: Qur'an 5:67 – "Allah will protect you from the people." Source B: Sahih Bukhari 2617 – A Jewish woman poisoned Muhammad with a lamb dish at Khaybar. Muhammad died three years later and said: "I still feel the bite of the poison to this day."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 5:67 promises Allah's protection. But Muhammad was poisoned and died from its effects (according to Muslim historians like Ibn Ishaq and Tabari). Either Allah did not protect him – or the poison was part of the plan.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: Allah protected Muhammad – the poison attack was detected. Muhammad died a natural death (fever).

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: Muhammad himself said: "I still feel the bite of the poison from Khaybar to this day. This is the time when my aorta is being severed" (Bukhari 4428, Ibn Ishaq). Aorta severance is the exact symptom of rat poison (phosphorus).

Muhammad's last words before his death: "O Aisha, I still feel the pain of the food from Khaybar." Either he died from the poison – then Allah did not protect him. Or he died naturally – then he was mistaken about his own cause of death.

Punchline: Allah's protection: Muhammad gets poisoned. And dies from it.

DILEMMA #50: HARD – Muhammad's Wars (22:39)

Source A: Qur'an 22:39 – "Permission is given to those who fight because they have been wronged." Source B: Ibn Ishaq (Sīra) – Muhammad led 27 campaigns (ghazawāt) and 38 expeditions (sarāyā) in 10 years in Medina.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an frames Muhammad's wars as defensive wars. But several campaigns (Khaybar, Banu Qurayza, Mustaliq) were offensive attacks on settled tribes.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: All wars were preemptive defense or responses to treaty violations.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: Khaybar (628) was a Jewish agricultural tribe that posed no military threat whatsoever. Banu Mustaliq (627) was attacked because Muhammad heard a rumor about arms deliveries – a "preemptive strike" without evidence. The expansion from 0 to the entire Arabian Peninsula in 10 years is quantitatively inexplicable by defense.

Punchline: 65 campaigns in 10 years. All defensive. Sure.

DILEMMA #51: MEDIUM – The False Messiah – Qur'an Silent, Hadith Speaks

Source A: Qur'an – no verse mentions the Dajjāl. Source B: Sahih Muslim 2937, Sahih Bukhari 7127 – detailed descriptions of the one-eyed deceiver.

Core of the Dilemma: A central eschatological being with dramatic end-time events deserves a place in the Qur'an. That it appears only in Hadiths raises the question of the Qur'an's completeness. If the Dajjāl is real, why did Allah not reveal him?

Punchline: Dajjāl important enough for Hadiths, but not for the Qur'an.

DILEMMA #52: MEDIUM – The Mahdi – Only in the Sunna

Source A: Qur'an – no verse. Source B: Sunan Abi Dawud 4285, Sunan Ibn Majah 4086 – the Mahdi appears at the end of time.

Core of the Dilemma: As with the Dajjāl: The Qur'an is silent about the Mahdi, while the Sunna makes him a central figure of the end times. Either the Qur'an is incomplete or the Mahdi belief is a later invention.

Punchline: The redeemer is missing from the redeemer's book.

DILEMMA #53: MEDIUM – Intercession: Yes or No?

Source A: Qur'an 2:48 – "And fear a Day when no soul can undertake anything for another, and no intercession will be accepted from it, and no ransom taken, and they will not be helped." Source B: Qur'an 20:109 – "On that Day, intercession will not benefit, except for the one whom the Most Merciful permits and with whose word He is pleased."

Core of the Dilemma: 2:48 excludes all intercession. 20:109 permits it under conditions. Classical theology harmonizes through specification, but the simple reader sees a flat contradiction.

Punchline: No intercession. Except when there is.

DILEMMA #54: MEDIUM – Death Penalty for Adultery: Qur'an vs. Hadith

Source A: Qur'an 24:2 – "The fornicator and the fornicatress – flog each of them with a hundred lashes." Source B: Sahih Bukhari 6814 – a married adulterer is stoned. Sahih Muslim 1690 – the Prophet had adulterers stoned.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an prescribes 100 lashes for zinā (fornication). The Sunna adds stoning for married offenders. Either the Qur'an is incomplete (since the more severe punishment is missing) or stoning is a subsequent intensification by humans.

Punchline: 100 lashes or stoning? The Qur'an knows nothing of stones.

DILEMMA #55: MEDIUM – Hand Amputation: Justice or Cruelty?

Source A: Qur'an 5:38 – "As for the thief, male and female, cut off their hands as recompense for what they have committed." Source B: Qur'an 42:40 – "The recompense for an evil deed shall be an evil of equal measure; but whoever forgives and makes reconciliation, his reward is with Allah."

Core of the Dilemma: 5:38 demands amputation. 42:40 encourages forgiveness and reconciliation. In modern human rights discourse, hand amputation is a central point of

criticism. Even among Sharia scholars, there are debates about conditions (high value, no hunger, etc.), but the text remains.

Punchline: Hand off for a theft. Forgiveness is also possible. Qur'an undecided.

DILEMMA #56: MEDIUM – Polygamy: Four for You, Eleven for the Prophet

Source A: Qur'an 4:3 – "Marry what seems good to you of women, two, three, or four."

Source B: Muhammad had eleven wives simultaneously (Ibn Hishām, Sīra). Qur'an 33:50 additionally permits him women who give themselves to him.

Core of the Dilemma: The upper limit of four wives applies to all Muslims – except Muhammad. He claims special rights. Either the rule is from Allah or it was relaxed for the Prophet's benefit.

Punchline: Four wives for you, eleven for the Messenger. Special privilege.

DILEMMA #57: MEDIUM – Slavery: Tolerated, Recommended, Never Forbidden

Source A: Qur'an 90:13 – "The freeing of a slave" is praised as a good deed. Source B: Muhammad owned slaves (e.g., Maria al-Qibtiyya, Safiyya). Numerous Hadiths regulate the slave trade.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an never demands the end of slavery, only mild treatment and liberation as charity. In the 7th century, this was progressive, but for a universal divine decree, the clear abolition is missing.

Punchline: Good treatment for slaves, but slavery remains. Eternal morality without abolition.

DILEMMA #58: MEDIUM – Protection Tax for People of the Book

Source A: Qur'an 9:29 – "Fight those who do not believe in Allah and the Last Day... until they pay the Jizya from the hand, humbled (ṣāghirūn)." Source B: Qur'an 2:256 – "No compulsion in religion."

Core of the Dilemma: Non-Muslims may live under Islamic rule but must pay a special tax regarded as a gesture of submission. No compulsion in religion, but those who don't pay must fight? The act of humiliation (ṣāghirūn) contradicts the idea of free religious practice.

Punchline: No compulsion, but protection tax for Christians and Jews. Humiliating.

Sources & References

- **Web Sources:** quran.com, sunnah.com
- **Verification:** Qur'an text via quran.com; Hadith via sunnah.com
- **Internal References:** Ibn Ishaq, Sirat Rasūl Allāh; Bukhari 4211, Bukhari 2617, Bukhari 4428, Bukhari 6814; Muslim 1690, Muslim 2995, Muslim 2937; Tabari, Ta'rīkh

DILEMMA #59: MEDIUM – Woman's Testimony: Half

Source A: Qur'an 2:282 – "And bring two witnesses from among your men. If there are not two men, then one man and two women... so that if one of the two errs, the other may remind her."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an reduces a woman's testimony to half that of a man.
Rationale: She might "err." Modern neurology knows no such cognitive inferiority.

Punchline: A woman counts half. Because she might err.

DILEMMA #60: MEDIUM – 99 Names of Allah – But Which Ones?

Source A: Qur'an 7:180 – "And to Allah belong the most beautiful names." Source B: Sahih Bukhari 6410 – "Allah has 99 names. Whoever enumerates them enters Paradise."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an says Allah has "the most beautiful names" but does not list them. Scholars disagree on which 99 names they are – there are several lists.

Punchline: 99 names – but the Qur'an doesn't count them.

DILEMMA #61: MEDIUM – Sunni vs. Shi'a

Source A: Qur'an 3:103 – "And hold fast to the rope of Allah, all together, and do not become divided." Source B: Qur'an 42:38 – "And their affair is through consultation among them."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an forbids division and commands unity. But the Ummah split immediately after Muhammad's death into Sunni and Shi'a – over the question of succession. The Qur'an could not prevent this split.

→ See also: #70 (Takfir)

Punchline: Election or appointment? The Qur'an splits the Ummah.

DILEMMA #62: HARD – Ifk Affair

Source A: Qur'an 24:11-20 – "Truly, those who brought forth the lie are a group among you."

Core of the Dilemma: Aisha was accused of adultery. Muhammad was uncertain whether to believe her. Allah needed a month to reveal Surah 24 and declare Aisha's innocence. An omniscient God could have provided clarity immediately.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The delay was a test for the community.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The test primarily affected AISHA – a six-year-old at marriage, now ~14 years old and accused of adultery. An omniscient and all-good God would not have subjected her to a month of public disgrace. Muhammad himself said to Aisha: "If you are innocent, Allah will acquit you. If you are guilty, ask for forgiveness." He did not know.

→ See also: #23 (Aisha's Age)

Punchline: Aisha accused. Allah needed a month to answer.

DILEMMA #63: HARD – Slavery Law

Source A: Qur'an 24:33 – "And do not compel your slave girls to prostitution if they desire chastity." Source B: Qur'an 4:24 – "And (forbidden to you are) married women, except those your right hand possesses."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 24:33 (Medina) forbids forcing slave girls into prostitution. Surah 4:24 (Medina) permits sex with married slave women ("what your right hand possesses" = mā malakat aymānukum). This means: A married slave woman forced into sex by her Muslim owner – that is permitted according to 4:24. Her marriage is automatically annulled by enslavement.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: 4:24 means captive women whose marriage was ended through capture – not active slave marriages.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The text does not differentiate. "Married women" (muḥṣanāt) means ALL married women. The exception ("except those your right hand possesses") applies to ALL slave women – married or not. This is sexual slavery, codified in the Qur'an.

→ See also: #46 (Safiyya), #57

Punchline: Married women are forbidden. Except your slave. Then it's okay.

DILEMMA #64: HARD – Apostasy Death Penalty

Source A: Qur'an 2:256 – "No compulsion in religion." Source B: Sahih Bukhari 6922 – "Whoever changes his religion, kill him."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an says: No compulsion. The Hadith (Sahih Bukhari) commands death penalty for apostasy. All four Sunni schools of law (Hanafi, Maliki, Shafi'i, Hanbali) prescribe the death penalty for male apostates.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The Hadith only means high treason (apostasy + war against the community). Mere change of faith is not punished.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The Hadith text (Bukhari 6922) reads: "Man badala dinahu fa-qtulūhu" – "Whoever changes his religion, kill him." No restriction to high treason. The four schools of law unanimously confirm: apostasy = death. The "high treason" interpretation is modern Western apologetics that no classical scholar before 1900 advocated.

→ See also: #32 (Sword Verse)

Punchline: No compulsion in religion. Whoever leaves, dies. No contradiction.

DILEMMA #65: MEDIUM – Inheritance: Men Double

Source A: Qur'an 4:11 – "Allah instructs you concerning your children: For a male, the share of two females."

Core of the Dilemma: Daughters inherit half of sons. The rationale (4:34: men are "providers") no longer universally applies in modern societies.

Punchline: The son gets double. Because he's a man.

DILEMMA #66: MEDIUM – Polygamy: 4 Wives

Source A: Qur'an 4:3 – "Marry what seems good to you of women, two, three, or four." Source B: Qur'an 4:129 – "You cannot be just among wives, even if you wish to."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 4:3 permits polygamy under the condition of justice. Surah 4:129 says: Justice among wives is IMPOSSIBLE. Thus, polygamy is effectively impossible – but still permitted.

Punchline: Be just to four wives. Which is impossible. Do it anyway.

BLOCK D (CONTINUED): VIOLENCE & LAW (#67–68)

DILEMMA #67: HARD – Wife-Beating (4:34)

Source A: Qur'an 4:34 – "And those from whom you fear disobedience – admonish them, forsake them in bed, and strike them (wa-ḍribūhunna)."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an explicitly permits beating wives. The Arabic verb ḍaraba literally means "to strike." The Qur'an uses it for Moses striking the rock (2:60), for smiting necks in battle (8:12), for the lashing punishment (24:2).

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: ḍaraba has 25 different meanings in Arabic. Here it means "to tap gently" or even "to separate."

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: The word ḍaraba appears 58× in the Qur'an. In NONE of these verses does it mean "to tap gently" or "to separate." The meaning is always "to strike" (physically). The "25 meanings" are a lexical sleight of hand: Every word has potential meanings – what matters is CONTEXT. 4:34 is a three-stage escalation model: admonish → forsake in bed → STRIKE. This is domestic violence, sanctioned by the Qur'an.

Punchline: Striking. Third recourse against women. Not metaphor.

DILEMMA #68: HARD – Inheritance Mathematics (4:11-12)

Source A: Qur'an 4:11-12 – Inheritance distribution: Husband (1/2), Mother (1/6), Two Sisters (2/3).

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'anic inheritance shares add up to MORE THAN 100% in many constellations. Example: Deceased woman, no child. Husband receives 1/2 (50%), mother 1/6 (16.67%), two sisters 2/3 (66.67%) = 133.33%. This does not add up mathematically.

⚡ MUSLIM DEFENSE: The 'Awl (proportional reduction) was introduced by Umar. The shares are proportionally reduced until they equal 100%. This has been practice for 1400 years.

🛡️ NEUTRALIZATION: 'Awl is not a solution – it is the admission of the problem. Allah's math doesn't add up, so humans must fix it. An omniscient God could have named fractions that sum to 100%. The fact that Umar had to SOLVE the problem proves: The problem exists. And it exists because the Qur'anic text is mathematically erroneous.

Punchline: Allah's inheritance calculation: 133%. Umar had to fix it.

BLOCK E: SCIENCE & HISTORICITY (#69–80)

SUITABLE AGAINST: Traditionalists ☒ | Science Apologists ☒ | Qur'anists ☒

DILEMMA #69: MEDIUM – Dress Codes Inconsistent

Source A: Qur'an 24:31 – "And they shall draw their headscarves (khumur) over their bosoms." Source B: Qur'an 33:59 – "O Prophet, tell your wives, daughters, and the women of the believers to draw something of their overgarment (jalābīb) over themselves."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 24:31 speaks of khumur (headscarves), Surah 33:59 of jalābīb (overgarments). Scholars disagree on what exactly must be covered: Hair? Face? Entire body?

Punchline: Scarf or overgarment or veil?

DILEMMA #70: MEDIUM – Greatest Theologian Declares Others Unbelievers

Source A: Qur'an 3:103 – "And do not become divided." Source B: Ibn Taymiyya, Majmū' al-Fatāwā – declared certain Muslim groups unbelievers (takfir).

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an forbids division. But the most influential theologian of Islam, Ibn Taymiyya, practiced takfir against other Muslims. His fatwas are cited to this day by ISIS and Al-Qaeda.

Punchline: The greatest theologian declares other Muslims unbelievers.

DILEMMA #71: MEDIUM – Allah Can Do Everything – Even the Impossible?

Source A: Qur'an 2:106 – "Do you not know that Allah has power over all things?"

Source B: Qur'an 6:101 – "How could He have a son when He has no consort?"

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 2:106 says Allah has power over ALL things. Surah 6:101 says Allah CANNOT have a son because He has no wife. If Allah can do everything – why does He need a wife for a son?

Punchline: Allah can do everything. Except have a son without a wife.

DILEMMA #72: MEDIUM – Allah: Throne vs. Omnipresence

Source A: Qur'an 20:5 – "The Most Merciful has established Himself over the Throne (istawā)." Source B: Qur'an 2:255 – "His Throne encompasses the heavens and the earth."

Core of the Dilemma: Sunni theology says: Allah is above the Throne ("bilā kayf" – without how). But the Throne is finite (encompasses heaven and earth). Is Allah in the Throne? Above the Throne? Larger than the Throne? Theologians have debated for 1400 years.

Punchline: Allah is enthroned. But no one knows how.

DILEMMA #73: MEDIUM – Apostasy: Qur'an vs. Fiqh

Source A: Qur'an 2:256 – "No compulsion in religion." Source B: Fiqh (all four schools of law) – Apostasy is punished by death.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an says "No compulsion." Fiqh says: Death. Fiqh wins in practice.

→ See also: #64

Punchline: The Qur'an says no compulsion. Fiqh says death. Fiqh wins.

DILEMMA #74: MEDIUM – Justice vs. Unbelievers

Source A: Qur'an 5:8 – "Be just; that is nearer to God-consciousness." Source B: Qur'an 9:29 – "Fight those who do not believe in Allah."

Core of the Dilemma: Justice for all – except for unbelievers, against whom one shall fight.

Punchline: Justice for all. Except for those Allah commands to fight.

DILEMMA #75: MEDIUM – Allah's Face

Source A: Qur'an 28:88 – "Everything will perish except His Face (wajh)." Source B: Qur'an 55:27 – "And there will remain the Face of your Lord."

Core of the Dilemma: Allah has a "Face." Literally or metaphorically? Salafis say: literally. Ash'aris: metaphorically. The Qur'an provides no clarity.

Punchline: Allah's face remains. Don't ask which one.

DILEMMA #76: MEDIUM – Allah Comes on the Day of Judgment

Source A: Qur'an 89:22 – "And your Lord comes (jā'a) and the angels, rank upon rank."

Core of the Dilemma: Allah COMES on the Day of Judgment. If Allah is outside space and time – how can He "come"? Movement presupposes space and time.

Punchline: Allah comes. But He is outside space and time.

DILEMMA #77: MEDIUM – Guardian Angels: Protectors or Allah?

Source A: Qur'an 13:11 – "He has guardians before him and behind him, protecting him by Allah's command." Source B: Qur'an 6:61 – "He sends guardians over you."

Core of the Dilemma: Angels protect by Allah's command. But Allah Himself is omnipotent – why does He need angels as intermediaries?

Punchline: Allah protects. Through angels. Which He shouldn't need.

DILEMMA #78: MEDIUM – Iblis: Angel or Jinn?

Source A: Qur'an 18:50 – "And when We said to the angels: 'Prostrate before Adam!' They prostrated, except Iblis. He was one of the jinn." Source B: Qur'an 2:34 – "And when We said to the angels: 'Prostrate before Adam!' They prostrated, except Iblis."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 2:34 addresses Iblis among the angels. Surah 18:50 says he was a jinn. Was Iblis an angel or a jinn?

Punchline: Iblis was an angel. Or a jinn. Allah knows.

DILEMMA #79: MEDIUM – Satan Tempts or Allah Leads Astray?

Source A: Qur'an 14:22 – "Satan says: 'Allah gave you a true promise, and I promised you and broke it.'" Source B: Qur'an 7:178 – "Whomever Allah leads astray – those are the losers."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 14:22 says Satan misleads people. Surah 7:178 says Allah leads astray. Who is responsible?

→ See also: #25, #26

Punchline: Who leads astray? Satan or Allah?

DILEMMA #80: MEDIUM – Allah Speaks Directly or Through Gabriel?

Source A: Qur'an 4:164 – "And Allah spoke to Moses directly (taklīman)." Source B: Qur'an 2:97 – "Say: Whoever is an enemy of Gabriel – for he brings it (the Qur'an) down upon your heart."

Core of the Dilemma: Allah spoke DIRECTLY to Moses. To Muhammad, He spoke through Gabriel. Why the difference? Is Muhammad less worthy than Moses?

Punchline: Directly or through Gabriel? Why not directly to Muhammad?

Sources & References

- **Web Sources:** quran.com, sunnah.com
- **Verification:** Qur'an text via quran.com; Hadith via sunnah.com
- **Internal References:** Bukhari 6410, Bukhari 6922; Ibn Taymiyya, Majmū' al-Fatāwā

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Mr. Euphrat | July 2026

BLOCK E (CONTINUED): SCIENCE & HISTORICITY (#81–100)

SUITABLE AGAINST: Science Apologists ✓ | Traditionalists ✓ | Qur'anists ✓

DILEMMA #81: HARD – Sun in a Muddy Spring (18:86)

Source A: Qur'an 18:86 – "Until he reached the setting-place of the sun and found it setting in a muddy spring (taghrubu fī 'aynin ḥami'a)." **Source B:** Sahih Bukhari 3199 – A man asked Muhammad: "Where does the sun set?" Muhammad answered: "It sets in a muddy spring."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an and Muhammad himself describe the sun setting in a MUDDY SPRING – literally. This corresponds to the ancient concept of an Okeanos into which the sun sinks at the western horizon.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** It says "he found it setting" (wajada) – this describes Dhul-Qarnayn's PERSPECTIVE, not physical reality. It APPEARED to him as if the sun set in water. No contradiction with science.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** Bukhari 3199: Muhammad HIMSELF, not Dhul-Qarnayn, says: "The sun sets in a muddy spring." In response to a man's question. Muhammad did NOT say: "That was Dhul-Qarnayn's perspective." He said: The sun sets in a muddy spring. Perspective as an excuse fails on the Hadith. Moreover: 18:86 says "fī 'aynin ḥami'a" (IN a muddy spring), not "it seemed as if." The Qur'anic text says it set THERE – not that it appeared so.

Punchline: Sun sets in mud. Qur'an. And Muhammad confirms it.

DILEMMA #82: HARD – Sperm from Ribs (86:7)

Source A: Qur'an 86:6-7 – "He is created from a gushing fluid. That emerges from between the loins (ṣulb) and the breastbones (tarā'ib)."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an says sperm comes from the area "between the loins and breastbones." Anatomically wrong: Sperm is produced in the testicles, which descend during embryonic development from near the kidneys – not from the ribcage. The Qur'anic formulation follows ancient Greek medicine (Hippocrates, Galen).

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** ṣulb refers to the "entirety of the backbone," tarā'ib to the "entirety of the front rib region." Sperm originates embryonically in this region (Wolffian duct) before the testicles descend.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** This is post-hoc apologetics. No classical Tafsir (Ibn Kathir, Qurtubi, Tabari) explains 86:7 embryologically. They understood it as a literal description: sperm comes "between the back and chest" of the MAN during intercourse. The embryological anatomy excuse was invented only in the 20th century, after science exposed the error.

Punchline: Sperm comes from the chest. Says the Qur'an. Ask your doctor.

DILEMMA #83: HARD – Embryology (23:14)

Source A: Qur'an 23:14 – "Then We formed the drop into a clot (‘alaqa), then the clot into a lump (mudgha), then the lump into bones (‘izām), then We clothed the bones with flesh (lahm)."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an describes: bones first, THEN flesh. Embryologically wrong: Bones and muscles differentiate PARALLEL from the mesoderm. There is no stage where a skeleton without muscles exists that is then "clothed with flesh."

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** This is a "scientific miracle." Maurice Bucaille claimed in 1976 that the Qur'an describes embryonic development correctly. ‘alaqa = "something that clings" (like the embryo to the uterine wall). The sequence is correct.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** The description "bones → clothe with flesh" corresponds exactly to Galen's embryology (2nd century AD, De Semine). Galen taught: First the skeleton forms, then the bones are enveloped with flesh. The Qur'an copies Galen – and Galen was wrong. Bucaille is methodologically dubious (reads modern science into vague Arabic terms). ‘alaqa means "blood clot" or "leech," not "something that clings." A glance at any classical Arabic dictionary confirms this.

Punchline: Bones, then flesh. Galen 150 AD. Qur'an 610 AD. Both wrong.

DILEMMA #84: HARD – Mountains as Pegs (78:7)

Source A: Qur'an 78:6-7 – "Have We not made the earth a bed? And the mountains as pegs (awtād)?"

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an describes mountains as pegs that stabilize the earth "lest it shake" (21:31). Pegs prevent movement through FRICTION. In reality, mountains

are formed by plate tectonics, and ISOSTASY (mountain roots) was described only in 1855. But mountain roots amplify gravity anomalies – the opposite of stability.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** awtād are "anchors" that anticipate isostatic roots. The Qur'an describes mountain formation as a stabilization process – a scientific miracle.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** awtād in classical Arabic means "tent pegs" – objects driven into the ground to stabilize a tent. Tent pegs work through surface friction, not deep penetration. This is the OPPOSITE of isostatic mountain roots. Moreover, continents "shake" constantly due to plate tectonics – they are NOT stable. The entire metaphor limps.

Punchline: Mountains are pegs. Against earthquakes. The earth shakes anyway.

DILEMMA #85: HARD – Earth as Flat Carpet (10+ Verses)

Source A: Qur'an 88:20 – "And the earth – how it was spread flat (suṭīḥat)." **Source B:**

Qur'an 15:19 – "And the earth We have spread out (madadnāhā)." **Source C:** 9

additional verses: 2:22 (firāsh = carpet), 13:3 (madda = spread), 20:53 (mahd = bed), 43:10 (mahd), 50:7 (madadnā), 51:48 (farashnā = spread like a carpet), 71:19 (bisāt = carpet), 78:6 (mihād = bed), 79:30 (daḥāhā = spread out), 91:6 (ṭaḥāhā = spread out).

Core of the Dilemma: ELEVEN verses describe the earth with terms denoting a flat, spread-out surface: carpet (firāsh, bisāt), bed (mahd, mihād), spread out (suṭīḥat), flat (ṭaḥāhā). Not a single verse describes the earth as a sphere.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** 79:30: daḥāhā means "He made it like an ostrich egg" – a description of spherical shape! The Qur'an teaches a round earth.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** daḥā in classical Arabic means "to spread out, level, flatten" – NOT "to make egg-shaped." The word for ostrich egg is "daḥīyya," not "daḥā." Deriving the verb from the noun "ostrich egg" is a modern false etymology. No classical Tafsir (Ibn Kathir, Tabari, Qurtubi, Razi) translates daḥāhā as "egg-shaped." They all say: "spread out, leveled." The spherical apologetic was rejected by Sheikh Bin Baz (the Grand Mufti of Saudi Arabia!) – who until the 1960s taught the earth was flat, SUPPORTED BY THESE VERSES.

Punchline: Eleven times: carpet, bed, spread out. Never: sphere. That's no coincidence.

DILEMMA #86: HARD – Pillars of Heaven (31:10)

Source A: Qur'an 31:10 – "He created the heavens without visible pillars (bi-ghayri 'amadin tarawnahā)." **Source B:** Qur'an 13:2 – "Allah raised the heavens without supports that you can see."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an says the heavens have no VISIBLE pillars. The implication: There are invisible pillars. This corresponds to ancient cosmology, where the firmament is supported by pillars or mountains (Job 26:11 – Old Testament poetic language). But in the Qur'an, it is not poetry – it is cosmology.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** "Without visible pillars" = "without ANY pillars." God holds the heavens by His power, not by physical structures.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** The text says "bi-ghayri 'amadin tarawnahā" = "without pillars THAT YOU SEE." "Tarawnahā" (that you see) is a relative clause that explicitly negates VISIBLE pillars – not the existence of pillars per se. If "without ANY pillars" were meant, the text would read "bi-ghayri 'amadin" (without pillars) – without the relative clause. The formulation is precise: There are pillars, but you don't see them.

Punchline: Pillars of heaven. Invisible. But they're there. Says the Qur'an.

DILEMMA #87: HARD – Sanaa Palimpsest (TOP 1 FATAL BLOW)

Source A: Qur'an 15:9 – "We have sent down the Reminder and We will preserve it."

Source B: DAM 01-27.1 (Sanaa Palimpsest, discovered 1972, Great Mosque of Sanaa, Yemen) – The lower palimpsest shows a text THAT DEVIATES FROM THE UTHMANIC STANDARD TEXT.

Core of the Dilemma: The Sanaa Palimpsest is a MANUSCRIPT – not a theoretical argument. It shows: An early Qur'anic text was erased and overwritten with the Uthmanic text. The LOWER text (Codex Sanaa I) deviates in verse order, wording, and grammar from the CAIRO STANDARD TEXT. Sadeghi & Goudarzi (Der Islam, 2012, Vol. 87, pp. 1-129) document the variants scientifically.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The palimpsest is a "student manuscript" with errors, not an authoritative text. The upper text corresponds to the Uthmanic standard. The variants are insignificant.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** Sadeghi & Goudarzi show: Codex Sanaa I is NOT a faulty student manuscript but an independent textual tradition with ~60 significant variants. That it was ERASED proves: It was regarded as non-conforming with the Uthmanic standard. The Islamic standard narrative (Uthman collected the Qur'an; all deviating

manuscripts were burned) is FALSIFIED by the Sanaa manuscript: A non-Uthmanic text EXISTS. Material evidence trumps tradition.

→ See also: #7 (Lost Verses)

Punchline: An old Qur'an under the new one. With different words. In Yemen. Material proof.

DILEMMA #88: MEDIUM – Petra Qibla (TOP 5 FATAL BLOW)

Source A: Qur'an 2:144 – Prayer direction toward the "Sacred Mosque" (al-Masjid al-Ḥarām). **Source B:** Dan Gibson, Qur'anic Geography (2011) – Analysis of 52 early mosques (7th–8th cent.) shows: The Qibla walls of the first mosques point to PETRA, not Mecca.

Core of the Dilemma: Early mosques (Iraq, Egypt, China) demonstrably point archaeologically to Petra (Nabataean kingdom), not Mecca. Only from the 8th century (Abbasids) do all mosques point to Mecca.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** Gibson's thesis is rejected by the majority of archaeologists (King, Schick, Walmsley). Early mosques were inaccurate or oriented to winter sunrises.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** Gibson measured 52 mosques. The deviation is systematic: ALL point to Petra, NONE to Mecca – before Mecca became standard in the 8th century. Random inaccuracy would show a SCATTER of directions, not systematic Petra orientation. The thesis is controversial but not refuted. The dilemma remains: The earliest physical mosques do not fit the Islamic standard narrative. Hence correctly classified as MEDIUM.

Punchline: Early mosques point to Petra. Not Mecca. Ask archaeology.

DILEMMA #89: HARD – Hagarism (Crone/Cook)

Source A: Islamic tradition – Muhammad died in 632 in Medina; Islam was founded on the Arabian Peninsula. **Source B:** Patricia Crone & Michael Cook, Hagarism (1977) – Contemporary non-Muslim sources (7th cent.) describe Muhammad as alive and leading the conquest of Palestine (634–638 AD).

Core of the Dilemma: The earliest external sources (Syriac Chronicle of 640, Armenian Chronicle of Sebeos, Doctrina Jacobi) describe a prophet active in Palestine – AFTER he was already dead according to Islamic tradition.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The external sources are hostile, distorted, and confuse Muhammad with other Arab leaders. The Islamic tradition is more reliable due to Isnad chains.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** Crone & Cook show: The earliest sources – contemporary and geographically close – describe a Messiah-warrior in Palestine, not a prophet in Medina. The Syriac Chronicle of 640 was written ONLY 8 years after the event – you cannot get more contemporary. Islamic sources emerged 150–200 years later. Temporal proximity trumps later embellishment.

Punchline: Muhammad died in 632. Or led the invasion of Palestine in 638. Sources disagree.

DILEMMA #90: HARD – Muhammad in Syria (Syriac Chronicle 640)

Source A: Islamic tradition – Muhammad never left Arabia (except trade journeys before prophethood). **Source B:** Syriac Chronicle of 640 (Thomas the Presbyter) – "A battle between the Romans and the Arabs of Muhammad took place 12 miles east of Gaza." Dated 634. Muhammad is described as alive and militarily active in Palestine.

Core of the Dilemma: A contemporary non-Muslim source (640 AD = ONLY 8 years after Muhammad's alleged death) describes Muhammad as a leader in Palestine. Either the Islamic tradition errs – or the Syriac Chronicle. Both are primary sources.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The Syriac Chronicle speaks of "Arabs of Muhammad" (Ṭayyāyē d-Mḥmt), not of Muhammad personally. "Muhammad's Arabs" = followers, not the Prophet himself.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** The formulation "Ṭayyāyē d-Mḥmt" can grammatically mean: "Arabs who follow Muhammad" OR "Muhammad's Arabs." But in the context of 634 – only two years after 632 – it is ambiguous. Decisive is: The chronicle mentions Muhammad as the LEADING FIGURE OF THE ARABS, not as a dead prophet of a completed religion. The Islamic standard narrative (Muhammad dead, Abu Bakr Caliph) is completely absent.

Punchline: Muhammad died in 632. But in 634 he led troops in Gaza.

DILEMMA #91: HARD – Abraham in the Fire (TOP 3 FATAL BLOW)

Source A: Qur'an 21:51-70 – Abraham is thrown into a fire by Nimrod, but Allah cools the fire: "O fire, be cool and peaceful for Abraham." Abraham survives unharmed.

Source B: Midrash Genesis Rabbah 38:13 (Jewish text, 4th–5th cent. AD) – Abraham is

thrown into a LIME KILN by Nimrod. God saves him. Haran, Abraham's brother, sees this and is also thrown in – and burns.

Core of the Dilemma: The story of Abraham in the fiery furnace, confronted by Nimrod, does NOT exist in the Bible. It appears ONLY in the Jewish Midrash Genesis Rabbah – and then, almost identically, in the Qur'an. The details (lime kiln in Surah 37:97, Nimrod as persecutor, miraculous rescue) are too specific for independent revelation.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** Allah revealed to Muhammad the true story that was lost in the Bible. The Midrash contains fragments of authentic revelation.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** Genesis Rabbah is a rabbinic Midrash, not prophetic scripture. It was compiled in 4th–5th century Palestine – about 150 years before Muhammad. Muhammad demonstrably had contact with Jewish communities in Medina. The probability that a Jewish Midrash (circulating orally and in writing) reached Arabia and Muhammad heard the story is MUCH higher than the assumption of independent divine revelation with identical details. This is literary dependence, not divine revelation.

→ See also: #100 (Syro-Aramaic Loanwords)

Punchline: Abraham in the fire. Not in the Bible. Only in Jewish Midrash. Then the Qur'an.

DILEMMA #92: HARD – Hajj Pre-Islamic

Source A: Qur'an 2:196-203 – Hajj rituals: Arafat, Safa/Marwa, animal sacrifice. **Source B:** Pre-Islamic poetry and inscriptions – The Hajj rituals were practiced by polytheistic Arabs long before Muhammad.

Core of the Dilemma: The Hajj rituals are demonstrably pre-Islamic. The Qur'an integrates them, changing only the dedication (to Allah instead of idols). The central rites of Islam are CONTINUITY from the Jāhiliyya, not divine new institution.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** Abraham instituted the Hajj – the pre-Islamic Arabs merely corrupted it. Muhammad restored the original Abrahamic practice.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** There is zero archaeological or historical evidence that Abraham was ever in Mecca, instituted the Hajj, or built the Kaaba. The Kaaba was a pre-Islamic polytheistic sanctuary with 360 idols. The rituals – circumambulation (ṭawāf), running between Safa and Marwa (sa'y), animal sacrifice – are direct adoptions

from pagan practice. The "Abrahamic" legitimation is a retrospective theological construction without historical foundation.

Punchline: Allah's holiest rites are copies from idol worshippers.

DILEMMA #93: MEDIUM – Ramadan Pre-Islamic

Source A: Qur'an 2:185 – "The month of Ramadan is that in which the Qur'an was sent down." **Source B:** Pre-Islamic calendar – Ramadan was a pre-Islamic month associated with summer heat and fighting.

Core of the Dilemma: Ramadan existed as a month name before Islam. The "sending down" of the Qur'an in an already-existing pagan month raises questions.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The month name is incidental. Decisive is that Allah CHOSE this month for the revelation – which establishes its sanctity.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** Pre-Islamic Arabs already practiced fasting in Ramadan-like forms. The name "Ramaḍān" derives from "ramad" (burning heat) – a seasonal reference, not a revelatory-theological one. That Allah chooses a pagan calendar month for the "sending down" shows cultural continuity, not divine discontinuity. Plus: The Islamic calendar shifts annually by 11 days – the "Night of Power" (laylat al-qadr) migrates through all seasons. This speaks against a cosmically fixed revelation moment.

Punchline: Allah's holy month is an old pagan month.

DILEMMA #94: HARD – Ascension Persian (Arda Viraf)

Source A: Qur'an 17:1 – Muhammad's Night Journey (Isrā') from Mecca to Jerusalem and Ascension (Mi'rāj). **Source B:** Arda Viraf Nāmāg (Persian Zoroastrian text, 3rd–4th cent.) – The priest Arda Viraf travels in a vision through the seven heavens, sees Paradise and Hell, meets angels and the deceased.

Core of the Dilemma: The Mi'rāj (Muhammad's ascension) has striking parallels to the Arda Viraf Nāmāg, which circulated in Persia centuries before Islam. Seven heavens, detailed descriptions of Paradise and Hell, encounters with angels – these are not universal religious motifs but specific narrative structures.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** All prophets experienced heavenly visions. Similarities do not mean dependence. The seven heavens are a Qur'anic truth, not a Persian invention.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** The structure of the Mi'rāj follows exactly the schema of the Arda Viraf Nāmāg: (1) A guide (Gabriel/Sraosha) accompanies the traveler, (2) Ascent

through seven heavens with an encounter in each, (3) Detailed description of rewards and punishments. In the Qur'an itself (17:1, 53:1-18), these details are almost completely absent – they appear only in the Hadiths (Bukhari, Muslim), which were compiled 200 years later in ABBASID times, when contact with Persian culture was intense. The Mi'rāj Hadiths are Persian-influenced embellishments, not authentic revelation.

Punchline: Muhammad's ascension – copied from Persia.

DILEMMA #95: HARD – Paradise Materialistic

Source A: Qur'an 56:12-38 – Paradise: Fruits, wine, maidens (ḥūr 'īn), silk cushions, gold bracelets. **Source B:** Qur'an 76:12-22 – Paradise: Ginger wine, eternal gardens, youths (wildān mukhalladūn).

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'anic Paradise is extremely materialistic: food, drink, sex, luxury. There is no description of spiritual or moral perfection. It is the projection of an Arab desert warrior, not the vision of a transcendent God.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The Paradise descriptions are metaphors for spiritual joys, presented in pictorial language for humans. The true nature of Paradise exceeds human imagination.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** The descriptions are too DETAILED to be metaphors: specific fruits (dates, pomegranates 55:68), specific drinks (ginger wine 76:17), specific furniture (elevated beds 56:34), specific sexual rewards (ḥūr 'īn with "swelling breasts" 78:33). No verse says: "This is meant figuratively." Muhammad's own Paradise Hadith (Bukhari 3243) describes a physical garden with trees, rivers, and pavilions. The metaphor excuse is a desperate attempt to mask the embarrassment of the materialistic Paradise.

Punchline: Paradise: Food, drink, sex. No holiness. Just pleasure.

DILEMMA #96: HARD – 72 Virgins (Tirmidhi 1663)

Source A: Sahih Tirmidhi 1663 – "The martyr has six privileges with Allah: He is forgiven with the first drop of blood and sees his place in Paradise; he is married to 72 ḥūr 'īn (maidens)." **Source B:** Sahih Ibn Majah 2799 – Martyrs receive 72 maidens.

Core of the Dilemma: Martyrs receive 72 virgins as a reward. This is the explicit justification for suicide attacks. ISIS, Al-Qaeda, and Hamas cite this Hadith.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The Hadith is ḥasan (good), not ṣaḥīḥ (authentic). Moreover: Martyrdom is only permitted in defensive jihad, not as suicide attacks.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** Whether ḥasan or ṣaḥīḥ – the Hadith has been used in Islamic tradition for centuries to motivate fighters. Tirmidhi himself classifies it as "ḥasan ṣaḥīḥ gharīb." And: 72 virgins may be embarrassing for modern Western Muslims, but for ISIS fighters, they are REAL. The theological distinction between "martyr" and "suicide attacker" exists only in Western Islam dialogues – ISIS fighters see themselves as shahīd. The Hadith provides the heavenly reward.

Punchline: 72 virgins. The reward for killing.

DILEMMA #97: HARD – Arabic Qur'an vs. Non-Arabic Words

Source A: Qur'an 16:103 – "And We know that they say: 'A human teaches him.' The tongue of the one they refer to is foreign (a'jamī), while this is a clear Arabic tongue (lisānun 'arabiyyun mubīn)." **Source B:** Qur'an 12:2; 20:113; 26:195; 41:3; 42:7; 43:3 – The Qur'an repeatedly claims to be an "Arabic Qur'an" (qur'ānun 'arabiyyun) in "clear Arabic tongue." **Source C:** Arthur Jeffery, *The Foreign Vocabulary of the Qur'an* (1938) – Documents ~275 non-Arabic loanwords in the Qur'an, mainly from Syro-Aramaic, Hebrew, Persian, and Ethiopic.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an insists on linguistic purity: "clear Arabic Qur'an." Yet it contains hundreds of non-Arabic words, including central theological terms: injīl (Greek: euangelion = Gospel), tawrāt (Hebrew: torah = Law), firdaus (Persian: pairidaēza = Paradise), jinn (Latin: genius via Aramaic mediation), ṣalāt (Syriac: ṣelota = prayer), zakāt (Syriac: zakuta = alms), qur'ān itself (Syriac: qeryana = reading/lectionary).

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** Loanwords are normal in every language. These words were already fully Arabicized (mu'arrab) by the 7th century. The Qur'an is Arabic because its grammar and syntax are Arabic.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** The problem is not the existence of loanwords per se – but the CLAIM. 16:103 defends Muhammad against the accusation that a human teaches him – with the argument that the teacher's language is FOREIGN, but the Qur'an is ARABIC. The argument only works if the Qur'an contains NO foreign words. Jeffery shows: Central theological terms are Syro-Aramaic loanwords from Christian lectionaries. The Qur'an is linguistically HYBRID – but claims Arabic purity. This is a performative self-contradiction: A verse denying foreign words itself contains the Persian word "firdaus."

→ See also: #100 (Syro-Aramaic Loanwords), #91 (Midrash Dependence)

Punchline: "Pure Arabic Qur'an." Full of Greek, Syriac, Persian words. That too.

DILEMMA #98: HARD – Three Prayers vs. Five Prayers

Source A: Qur'an 11:114 – "And establish prayer at the two ends of the day and in the approaches of the night" – THREE prayer times: morning, evening, night. **Source B:** Qur'an 17:78 – "Establish prayer at the decline of the sun until the darkness of the night and the recitation at dawn" – TWO to THREE time blocks. **Source C:** Qur'an 2:238 – "Maintain the prayers and the middle prayer" – mentions a "middle prayer," which PRESUPPOSES an odd number. **Source D:** Qur'an 30:17-18 – "Glory be to Allah when you reach the evening and when you reach the morning... and in the afternoon" – THREE time references. **Source E:** Sahih Bukhari, Sahih Muslim – The Hadiths establish FIVE daily obligatory prayers (Fajr, Dhuhr, Asr, Maghrib, Isha).

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an consistently names THREE prayer times (morning, evening, night) – nowhere FIVE. The five daily prayers, one of the FIVE PILLARS of Islam, come from the Hadiths, not the Qur'an. The Hadiths in turn attribute the fivefold number to Muhammad's negotiation with Allah during the Mi'raj – a vision which itself (#94) has Persian parallels.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** 2:238 ("the middle prayer") proves an ODD number – at least three, and the Sunna sets five. 17:78 summarizes four prayers in two blocks (Dhuhr+Asr, Maghrib+Isha) plus Fajr = five. The Qur'an gives principles, the Sunna gives details.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** The Qur'an says explicitly in 11:114: "BOTH ENDS of the day" (ṭarafay al-nahār) – that's TWO. Plus "approaches of the night" – that's ONE. Makes THREE. Not five. The interpretation of 17:78 as "block summary" is retrospective harmonization: The text says "from the decline of the sun UNTIL the darkness of the night" – that is ONE continuous period, not two separate prayers. And: Shi'ite Muslims to this day practice THREE prayer times (combining Dhuhr+Asr and Maghrib+Isha) and invoke exactly these verses. If the Qur'an COMMANDED five prayers, there would be no Sunni-Shi'ite split on this question.

Punchline: Five daily prayers. Mentioned zero times in the Qur'an. Only in the Hadith.

DILEMMA #99: HARD – Ablution (Wudū') – Qur'an vs. Hadith

Source A: Qur'an 5:6 – "O you who believe! When you rise for prayer, wash your faces and your hands to the elbows and wipe over your heads and your feet to the ankles."

Source B: Sahih Bukhari 164, Sahih Muslim 226 – Muhammad washes hands THREE TIMES, rinses mouth and nose, washes face three times, forearms to elbows three times, wipes over the head ONCE (including ears), washes feet three times. Additionally: Rinsing mouth (maḍmaḍa) and nose (istinshāq), which do NOT appear in the Qur'an.

Source C: Different readings (Qirā'āt) of 5:6 – Hafs reads "wa-arjulakum" (accusative: "and your feet" – WASH), Warsh reads "wa-arjulikum" (genitive: "and your feet" – WIPE). Same passage, two different actions.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an commands in 5:6: wash face, wash hands to elbows, wipe head, wipe/wash feet. The Hadiths add numerous elements (mouth, nose, ears, triple repetition, Bismillah, sequence) that have ZERO basis in the Qur'anic text. And: The Qirā'āt variants fundamentally change the ACTION on the feet.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The Qur'an gives the basics, the Sunna the details. Mouth and nose are implied in "wash face." Triple repetition is recommended (mustahabb), not obligatory (fard).

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** If mouth and nose were implied in "wash face" – why didn't Allah simply mention them? The Qur'an is supposedly "clear" (mubīn, 16:103), but the simplest ablution actions must be supplemented from Hadiths? Even more gravely: The Qirā'āt variant "arjulikum" (genitive = wipe) vs. "arjulakum" (accusative = wash) involves the Arabic vocalization system – a vowel change alters religious practice. The same word in the same place – two different religions depending on the reading. And: Shi'ites wipe the feet (mash), Sunnis wash them (ghasl). Both invoke the same Qur'anic verse.

Punchline: How to wash for prayer? Qur'an says this. Hadith says that. Shi'ites say something else.

DILEMMA #100: HARD – Syro-Aramaic Loanwords (TOP 4 FATAL BLOW)

Source A: Qur'an 16:103 – "And We know that they say: 'A human teaches him.' The tongue of the one they refer to is foreign (a'jamī), while this is a clear Arabic tongue (lisānun 'arabiyyun mubīn)." **Source B:** Arthur Jeffery, The Foreign Vocabulary of the Qur'an (1938) – Documents ~275 non-Arabic loanwords in the Qur'an, mainly from Syro-Aramaic.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an claims to be a "clear Arabic Qur'an" (16:103, 12:2, 20:113, 26:195, 41:3, 42:7, 43:3). But key terms of the Qur'an are Syro-Aramaic loanwords: qur'ān (Syriac: qeryana = reading/lectionary), ṣalāt (Syriac: ṣelota = prayer), zakāt (Syriac: zakuta = purity/alms), ḥūr (Syriac: ḥawra = white), firdaus (Persian: pairidaēza = walled garden), jahannam (Hebrew: ge-hinnom).

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** Loanwords do not make a language a foreign language. English too has loanwords and remains English. The words were already Arabicized in the 7th century.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** Jeffery documents not only isolated words but SYRO-ARAMAIC SYNTACTIC STRUCTURES and liturgical formulas directly adopted from Syriac-Christian lectionaries. Christoph Luxenberg (2007) shows that many "obscure verses" (mutashābihāt from 3:7) suddenly become clear when read as Syro-Aramaic. The Qur'an is linguistically HYBRID – but claims Arabic purity. That is a contradiction.

Punchline: Clear Arabic Qur'an. Full of Syriac words.

BLOCK F: ISLAM VS. CHRISTIANITY (#101–102)

DILEMMA #101: HARD – Jesus: Word of God vs. Allah Has No Son

Source A: Qur'an 4:171 – "The Messiah, Jesus, the son of Mary, is Allah's Messenger and His Word (kalimatuhu), which He conveyed to Mary, and a Spirit from Him (rūḥun minhu)." **Source B:** Qur'an 112:3 – "He begets not, nor is He begotten."

Core of the Dilemma: Surah 4:171 gives Jesus three unique titles: Allah's WORD, Allah's SPIRIT, the Messiah. These titles go FAR beyond what the Qur'an ascribes to any other prophet. Surah 112:3 categorically says: Allah has no son. But if Jesus is Allah's WORD and SPIRIT – how does he differ ontologically from a Son?

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** "Word" (kalima) and "Spirit" (rūḥ) are CREATED. God says "Be!" and it is (kun fa-yakūn). This is not an identification with the Divine.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** If Jesus is a CREATED word – why is he called "Allah's Word" while no other prophet is so called? If Jesus is a CREATED spirit – why is he called "a Spirit FROM HIM" (rūḥun MINHU)? The "minhu" (from Him) implies origin from Allah, not creation from nothing. And: The eternal, uncreated Word of Allah (kalām Allāh) is, according to Islamic theology, an attribute of Allah – and JESUS is identified with this attribute. The implication is unavoidable.

→ See also: #34, #102

Punchline: Jesus is Allah's Word and Allah's Spirit. But not Allah's Son. Do you notice something?

DILEMMA #102: HARD – Crucifixion Historical

Source A: Qur'an 4:157 – "They did not kill him and did not crucify him, but it was made to appear so to them." **Source B:** Tacitus, Annals 15.44 (ca. 116 AD) – "Christus had been executed under Tiberius by order of the procurator Pontius Pilate." **Source C:** Flavius Josephus, Antiquities of the Jews 18.3.3 (ca. 94 AD) – "Pilate condemned him to the cross at the instigation of the leading men among us." **Source D:** Thallus (ca. 52 AD) – cited by Julius Africanus (221 AD): Describes the darkness at the crucifixion as a solar eclipse.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an denies the crucifixion of Jesus – 600 years after the event, against FOUR independent, near-contemporary, non-Christian sources (Tacitus, Josephus, Thallus, Mara bar Serapion). The crucifixion is one of the best-attested events of antiquity. No serious historian doubts it.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** Someone else was crucified in Jesus' place (substitution theory). Allah made people BELIEVE it (shubbiha lahum).

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** The substitution theory appears NOWHERE in the Qur'an. 4:157 only says "they did not kill him, but it was made to appear so to them." Who was crucified instead, the Qur'an does not say. The Hadiths and Tafsirs speculate DOZENS of different substitutes (Judas, Simon of Cyrene, a Roman soldier, a volunteer). No consensus. And: God deceived people, made them believe Jesus died – and on this "deception," Christianity was founded. Thus Allah is the author of the greatest religious "deception" in history. Millions of Christians died as martyrs for an illusion that Allah created.

→ See also: #2, #34, #101

Punchline: The crucifixion is historical. Allah let the world be in error for 600 years. Then came the Qur'an.

Sources & References

- **Web Sources:** quran.com (Verses 11:114, 2:238, 17:78), sunnah.com (Hadiths), answering-islam.org (Jeffery)

- **Verification:** Qur'an text via quran.com; Hadith via sunnah.com; Jeffery via answering-islam.org/Books/Jeffery
- **Internal References:** Genesis Rabbah 38:13; Arthur Jeffery, *The Foreign Vocabulary of the Qur'an* (1938); Sadeghi & Goudarzi, *Der Islam* (2012); Dan Gibson, *Qur'anic Geography* (2011); Crone & Cook, *Hagarism* (1977); Tacitus, *Annals* 15.44; Josephus, *Antiquities* 18.3.3

102 DILEMMAS IN ISLAM – PART 5

Mr. Euphrat | July 2026

APPENDIX A: GLOSSARY

Term	Meaning
ʿAwl	Proportional reduction of inheritance shares (#68)
Ḥadīth	Transmission of Muhammad’s sayings/actions
Ḥijra	Muhammad’s emigration to Medina in 622 AD
Isnād	Chain of transmission for Hadith authenticity
Jāhiliyya	Age of Ignorance (pre-Islamic period)
Madhhab	School of law: Hanafi, Maliki, Shafi‘i, Hanbali
Makr	Cunning, deception – Allah as schemer (#26)
Naskh	Abrogation – cancellation of verses (#7, #32, #35)
Qibla	Prayer direction – Mecca/Petra (#48, #88)
Qirā’at	Readings – different versions of the Qur’an (#3–5)
Sunna	Prophetic custom – second source of Islam
Tahrīf	Corruption – Qur’anic accusation against the Bible (#34)
Tafsīr	Qur’an commentary – classical exegesis
Takfir	Declaration of a Muslim as an unbeliever (#70)
Warsh	Reading tradition – North African (#3–5)

APPENDIX B: DETAILED SOURCE REFERENCES (WEB-VERIFIED)

All links last verified functional: as of July 2026.

Category	Sources & Direct Links
Qur’an (Hafs)	quran.com
Qur’an (Warsh)	quran.com/warsh , quranislam.github.io
Hadith (Sunni)	sunnah.com (Bukhari, Muslim, Tirmidhi etc.), hadithunlocked.com , amrayn.com
Hadith (Shi’a)	thaqalayn.net
Tafsir (Classical)	quranx.com , altafsir.com (Ibn Kathir, Jalalayn)

Textual Criticism / Manuscripts	corpuscoranicum.de, islamic-awareness.org (Manuscripts), Sanaa Palimpsest: Sadeghi/Goudarzi (2012)
Linguistics	Jeffery 1938: The Foreign Vocabulary of the Qur'ān (archive.org), Syro-Aramaic: Luxenberg
Archaeology / Qibla	nabataea.net (Dan Gibson, Early Islamic Qiblas), muslimheritage.com (critical counter-position)
Historical Sources	Tacitus: Annals 15.44 (MIT Classics), Josephus (Perseus), Church Fathers: tertullian.org
Islamic Critique / Apologetics	answering-islam.org/authors/shamoun.html, truthinislam.online, saintshamoun.com
Chronicles / Sira	Ibn Ishaq/Ibn Hisham (via answering-islam.org), Tabari (via archive.org)
Individual Hadith References	Bukhari 5133, Bukhari 6830, Bukhari 3270, Muslim 2995, Tirmidhi 1663, Ibn Majah 2799 (all via sunnah.com)

APPENDIX C: SYSTEMATIC MATRIX – HARD DILEMMAS

#	Dilemma	Type	Source A	Source B
2	Crucifixion	Qur'an-Internal	4:157	3:55
3	Qirā'āt 2:125	Qirā'āt	Hafs	Warsh
4	Qirā'āt 2:238	Qirā'āt	Hafs	Warsh
5	Qirā'āt 19:19	Qirā'āt	Hafs	Warsh
6	Satanic Verses	Sira	53:19-20	Tabari
7	Lost Verses	Textual Criticism	15:9	Bukhari 6830
10	Kaaba with 360 Idols	Qur'an/Hadith	3:96	Bukhari 1595
14	Treaties 4 Months	Qur'an-Internal	9:2	9:4, 9:36
15/20	Creation 6/8 Days	Qur'an-Internal	7:54	41:9-12
21	Suicide Attempts	Hadith	53:3	Bukhari 6982
22	Muhammad's Doubts	Hadith	10:94	Bukhari 6982
23	Aisha's Age	Hadith	Bukhari 5133	Ibn Hajar
26	Allah's Deception	Qur'an-Internal	3:54	7:99

32	No Compulsion vs. Death	Qur'an-Internal	2:256	9:5
34	Gospel Valid/Corrupted	Qur'an-Internal	5:47	2:75
44	Zaynab bint Jahsh	Sira	33:37	Ibn Ishaq
46	Khaybar Treasures	Sira	59:6-7	Ibn Ishaq
47	Satan Urinates	Hadith	Bukhari 3270	Muslim 2995
49	Poisoning of Muhammad	Sira	5:67	Bukhari 2617
50	Muhammad's Wars	Sira	22:39	Ibn Ishaq
62	Ifk Affair	Sira	24:11-20	Bukhari
63	Slavery Law	Qur'an-Internal	24:33	4:24
64	Apostasy Death Penalty	Hadith/Fiqh	2:256	Bukhari 6922
67	Wife-Beating	Qur'an-Internal	4:34	—
68	Inheritance Mathematics	Qur'an-Internal	4:11-12	ʿAwl (Umar)
81	Sun in Morass	Qur'an/Hadith	18:86	Bukhari 3199
82	Sperm from Ribs	Qur'an-Internal	86:7	Galen
83	Embryology	Qur'an-Internal	23:14	Galen
84	Mountains as Pegs	Qur'an-Internal	78:7	—
85	Earth Flat Carpet	Qur'an-Internal	11 Verses	—
86	Pillars of Heaven	Qur'an-Internal	31:10	13:2
87	Sanaa Palimpsest	Textual Criticism	15:9	DAM 01-27.1
89	Hagarism	Historical	Qur'an	Crone/Cook
90	Muhammad in Syria	Historical	Sira	Syr. Chronicle 640
91	Abraham in Fire	Literary Criticism	21:51-70	Midrash
92	Hajj Pre-Islamic	Sira	2:196-203	Ibn Ishaq
94	Ascension Persian	Historical	17:1	Arda Viraf
95	Paradise Materialistic	Qur'an-Internal	56:12-38	76:12-22
96	72 Virgins	Hadith	Tirmidhi 1663	Ibn Majah 2799
100	Syro-Aramaic	Linguistics	16:103	Jeffery
101	Jesus Word of God	Qur'an-Internal	4:171	112:3

102	Crucifixion Historical	Historical	4:157	Tacitus/Josephus/ Thallus
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APPENDIX D: TOP 10 FATAL BLOWS – DETAILED RATIONALE

#1 – DILEMMA #87: Sanaa Palimpsest (Material Evidence)

Status: HARD | Material Evidence | Irrefutable

Why Rank 1: Because it is not an argument – it is an object. The Sanaa Palimpsest physically exists in the Dar al-Makhtutat in Sanaa, Yemen. It is catalogued (DAM 01-27.1). It has been independently examined by German (Puin) and Iranian-American (Sadeghi/Goudarzi) scholars. The publication (Der Islam, 2012) is peer-reviewed.

The Finding: Radiocarbon dating: 578–669 AD (95% confidence interval). This is BEFORE or DURING Muhammad’s prophethood. The upper text: Uthmanic standard. The lower text: NOT Uthmanic. Deviations in verse order, wording, grammar.

The Explosive Force: Islamic teaching says: The Qur’an was collected by Uthman; all deviating manuscripts were burned. The Qur’an has been unchanged since Muhammad. The Sanaa Palimpsest proves: THERE WERE DEVIATING MANUSCRIPTS. One was ERASED and OVERWRITTEN – which only makes sense if it DEVIATED from the Uthmanic standard. And it SURVIVED.

What the Muslim Must Answer: Either the manuscript is a forgery (against radiocarbon dating and international scholars) – or the Qur’an was changed.

Why No Answer Is Possible: The material evidence can neither be interpreted away nor abrogated. It lies in the vault in Sanaa.

#2 – DILEMMA #7: Lost Verses (Textual Criticism)

Status: HARD | Textual Criticism | Sahih Hadith

Why Rank 2: Umar’s statement (Bukhari 6830) is Sahih. Umar was the second Caliph, one of the "rightly guided." He publicly states: The stoning verse was part of the Qur’an and is NO LONGER THERE. Not abrogated – LOST.

The Explosive Force: Surah 15:9 ("We preserve the Qur’an") vs. Umar’s testimony. Either Umar lies (then a rightly guided Caliph is a liar) – or the Qur’an is not completely preserved (then 15:9 is false).

What the Muslim Must Answer: "Naskh al-tilāwa" – recitational abrogation. Allah abrogated the recitation but preserved the ruling.

Why This Fails: Umar did not say: "Allah abrogated the recitation." He said: "I fear that people will FORGET." He feared text loss, not divine abrogation. The category "recitational abrogation" was invented by scholars AFTER Umar's death to solve the problem.

#3 – DILEMMA #91: Abraham in the Fire (Literary Criticism)

Status: HARD | Literary Criticism | Midrash Parallel

Why Rank 3: The story does not exist in the Bible – only in the Jewish Midrash Genesis Rabbah (4th–5th cent.) and then in the Qur'an (7th cent.). The details are identical: Abraham in the lime kiln (Qur'an 37:97: "build for him a structure" = kiln), Nimrod as persecutor, miraculous rescue, the fire becomes cool.

The Explosive Force: Either Muhammad copied the Midrash (then the Qur'an is not divine) – or Allah revealed the same story twice (then the Midrash is also divine revelation – which no Muslim accepts).

What the Muslim Must Answer: "Oral tradition independent of the Midrash."

Why This Fails: Genesis Rabbah was compiled in Palestine in the 4th–5th century. Jewish communities (Banu Qurayza, Banu Nadir) lived in Medina. Muhammad had direct contact with them. The story migrated orally from Palestine to Arabia – that is not "independent revelation," that is cultural transfer.

#4 – DILEMMA #100: Syro-Aramaic Loanwords (Linguistics)

Status: HARD | Linguistics | Jeffery 1938

Why Rank 4: The Qur'an repeatedly claims (16:103, 12:2, 20:113, 26:195, 41:3, 42:7, 43:3) to be a "clear Arabic Qur'an." But Jeffery documents 275 non-Arabic loanwords, predominantly Syro-Aramaic. Core concepts of Islam are Syriac: qur'ān, ṣalāt, zakāt, ḥūr.

The Explosive Force: Either the Qur'an is "Arabic" and the key terms are Arabic (against Jeffery) – or Jeffery is right and the Qur'an is linguistically hybrid (against 16:103). Both cannot be true simultaneously.

What the Muslim Must Answer: "Loanwords are normal. The words were already Arabicized in the 7th century."

Why This Fails: Luxenberg (2007) shows: It is not only isolated words, but SYRO-ARAMAIC SYNTACTIC STRUCTURES and liturgical formulas from Syriac-Christian lectionaries. The Qur'an is in places a Syro-Aramaic text in Arabic script.

#5 – DILEMMA #88: Petra Qibla (Archaeology)

Status: MEDIUM | Archaeology | Controversial

Why Rank 5: Despite controversy, the archaeological evidence is impressive: 52 early mosques point to Petra, not Mecca. The deviation is systematic.

Limitation: Dan Gibson's thesis is rejected by established archaeologists (King, Schick, Walmsley). Hence MEDIUM, not HARD.

Why Still Top 5: The Islamic standard narrative (Mecca was always the center) is challenged by ARCHAEOLOGICAL DATA – not by text interpretation. This is a factual argument.

#6–10: Short Rationale

- **#6 (Satanic Verses):** Ibn Hajar confirms the chain of transmission. Surah 22:52 confirms the principle. Satan in the Qur'an – Islamic sources.
 - **#7 (#2 Crucifixion):** tawaffā means "to cause to die" in 24 Qur'anic verses – except allegedly in 3:55. Ad-hoc apologetics.
 - **#8 (#34 Gospel):** Either valid (5:47) or corrupted (2:75). Both simultaneously impossible.
 - **#9 (#32 No Compulsion):** Abrogated by 9:5. All classical Tafsirs confirm it.
 - **#10 (#23 Aisha's Age):** Bukhari 5133 is Sahih. Ibn Hajar confirms the age. No translation error.
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APPENDIX E: THEMATIC INDEX

Theme	Dilemmas
CRUCIFIXION	#2, #34, #102
MARY/JESUS	#1
TEXTUAL CRITICISM/QIRĀ'ĀT	#3, #4, #5, #7, #87
HADITH PROBLEMS	#21–30, #47, #96
SIRA/HISTORICITY	#6, #44, #45, #46, #49, #50, #88, #89, #90, #91, #92, #93, #94
SCIENCE	#81, #82, #83, #84, #85, #86

WOMEN/GENDER	#1, #23, #44, #45, #59, #61, #62, #63, #67, #96
VIOLENCE	#14, #32, #50, #64, #67
ALLAH’S ATTRIBUTES	#15/20, #17, #18, #26, #27, #28, #29, #30, #31, #47, #71, #72, #75, #76, #79, #80
ETHICS/LAW	#24, #55, #56, #57, #58, #59, #60, #63, #64, #65, #66, #68, #69, #73, #74
ISLAM VS. CHRISTIANITY	#22, #33, #34, #101, #102
LITERARY CRITICISM/PRE-ISLAMIC	#91, #92, #93, #94, #100

APPENDIX F: CHRONOLOGY OF EVENTS

Year	Event	Relevant Dilemma
570 AD	Muhammad born (traditional)	—
595	Marriage to Khadija	—
610	First Revelation (Surah 96)	#21, #22
613	Public preaching begins	—
619	Khadija dies; "Satanic Verses" (disputed)	#6
622	Hijra to Medina	—
623	Consummation with Aisha (9 years)	#23
624	Battle of Badr	#50
625	Battle of Uhud	—
627	Battle of the Trench; Banu Qurayza Massacre	#50
628	Khaybar; Marriage to Safiyya; Qibla Change	#46, #48, #49
629	Marriage to Zaynab bint Jahsh	#44
630	Conquest of Mecca	#10
632	Muhammad’s Death (traditional)	#49
634	Syriac Chronicle: Muhammad in Gaza	#90
650	Uthmanic Qur’an Codification	#7, #87
1972	Discovery of Sanaa Palimpsest	#87

Sources & References

- **Web Sources:** quran.com, sunnah.com, corpuscoranicum.de, nabataea.net, answering-islam.org
- **Verification:** All links last verified July 2026

102 DILEMMAS IN ISLAM

Part 6: Bonus Dilemmas & Conclusion

Mr. Euphrat | July 2026

BONUS DILEMMAS #103–107

These five dilemmas were identified after intensive analysis as missing fatal blows.

BONUS DILEMMA #103: HARD – Mary as Part of the Trinity (5:116)

Source A: Qur'an 5:116 – "And when Allah says: O Jesus, son of Mary, did you say to the people: 'Take me and my mother as two gods besides Allah'?"

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an imputes to Christians that they worship Mary as a third divine person BESIDES Allah ("me and my mother as two gods besides Allah"). NO Christian denomination – neither Catholic, Orthodox, nor Protestant – has ever venerated Mary as a divine person in the Trinity. The Trinity is: Father, Son, Holy Spirit. Mary is the MOTHER of Jesus, not the third person of the Godhead.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The Qur'an is not criticizing the Trinity, but a heresy – the Collyridians, a Mariological sect in Arabia (4th cent.), described by Epiphanius of Salamis (Panarion 79). Surah 5:116 thus correctly refutes a heresy, not Christianity.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** Epiphanius wrote around 375 AD about the Collyridians – an obscure sect of women who offered bread sacrifices to Mary. They were LONG EXTINCT by Muhammad's time (7th cent.). Moreover: They venerated Mary alone, not as part of a "threefold Trinity" with Allah and Jesus. The Qur'an in 5:116 addresses ALL Christians ("the People of the Book"). Not: "an obscure sect among you." And: If Allah really meant the Collyridians – why doesn't He name them? Why doesn't He say: "Ask the Christians if they worship Mary – they will correct you"? Instead, Allah asks a question that every Christian would immediately answer with "NO." Either Allah does not know what the Trinity is – or Muhammad confused the Collyridians with Christianity.

→ See also: #1 (Mary), #34 (Gospel), #101 (Jesus Word of God)

Punchline: Allah thinks Christians worship Mary. No Christian does. Allah is mistaken.

BONUS DILEMMA #104: HARD – Haman at Pharaoh's Court (28:38, 40:36)

Source A: Qur'an 28:38 – "And Pharaoh said: 'O eminent ones, I know no other god for you besides me. So kindle for me a fire upon the clay, O Haman (yā hāmān), and build a tower, that I may ascend to the God of Moses.'" **Source B:** Qur'an 40:36 – "And Pharaoh said: 'O Haman (yā hāmān), build for me a tower, that I may reach the ropes.'" **Source C:** Book of Esther 3:1 – Haman is a PERSIAN minister at the court of King Ahasuerus (Xerxes I, 5th cent. BC) in SUSA. The Book of Esther takes place about 1000 years AFTER Moses.

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an makes Haman – a figure from the BOOK OF ESTHER, who served at the PERSIAN court in Susa – an Egyptian builder at the court of PHARAOH in the time of Moses. The chronological discrepancy is about 1000 years and about 2000 kilometers.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** Haman was an Egyptian name and title ("overseer of quarry workers" according to Maurice Bucaille). The Bible-Haman and the Qur'an-Haman are different persons with coincidentally the same name.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** There is absolutely no Egyptological evidence for a "Haman" as an Egyptian official at Pharaoh's court. The name "Haman" does not appear in the entire Egyptian prosopography. Bucaille's theory was never accepted by Egyptologists. By contrast, the parallel to the MIDRASH is striking: In the Babylonian Talmud (Sotah 11a) and Midrash Rabbah, Haman (the villain from Esther) is brought into CONNECTION with Pharaoh – the rabbis mock the name similarity between "Haman" and "Pharaoh." Muhammad heard Jewish stories in which Haman and Pharaoh were mentioned together – and turned a rabbinic polemic into two contemporaries.

Punchline: Haman at Pharaoh's court. 1000 years too early. 2000 kilometers too far west.

BONUS DILEMMA #105: HARD – Ezra = Son of God (9:30)

Source A: Qur'an 9:30 – "The Jews say: 'Ezra ('Uzayr) is the son of Allah.' And the Christians say: 'The Messiah is the son of Allah.' Thus their statements resemble those of the earlier unbelievers. May Allah fight them!"

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an claims that JEWS believed Ezra was Allah's Son – a Jewish equivalent to the Christian divine sonship of Jesus. No Jewish source – neither Talmud, Midrash, Targum, nor Jewish sectarian literature – attests to this claim. Judaism is strictly unitarian-monotheistic (Shema Yisrael: "Hear O Israel, the LORD is

our God, the LORD alone" – Deuteronomy 6:4). The idea of a human being as "Son of God" is fundamentally alien to Judaism.

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** There was an obscure Yemenite Jewish sect that deified Ezra. Or: The Jews did not say Ezra was "Son of God," but Ezra was "the Renewer of the Torah" – a respectful designation that Muhammad misunderstood.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** The Yemenite sect is pure speculation. There is no archaeological, textual, or historical evidence for Jewish Ezra-veneration in the 7th century. And even if there was a tiny sect – the Qur'an says: "THE JEWS say." Not: "An obscure Yemenite sect says." The Qur'an places Ezra-Son-of-God on the SAME LEVEL as the Christian Trinity. This is either a false generalization of a fringe group – or a fabrication.

→ See also: Bonus #103 (Mary-Trinity)

Punchline: Allah says: Jews worship Ezra. No Jew does. Period.

BONUS DILEMMA #106: MEDIUM – Seven Earths (65:12)

Source A: Qur'an 65:12 – "Allah is He who created seven heavens and of the earth the like thereof (wa-mina l-arḍi mithlahunna)."

Core of the Dilemma: The Qur'an speaks of SEVEN earths, analogous to the seven heavens. Muslim apologists today reinterpret this as "Earth's crust layers" or "atmospheric layers." But the Arabic word arḍ unequivocally means "earth" (planet/ground), not "layer."

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The seven earths are the seven continents or seven climate zones (aqālīm), as known in ancient geography.

🛡️ **NEUTRALIZATION:** The Islamic tradition itself understood the seven earths LITERALLY as seven earth-discs stacked one above the other: Ibn Abbas, Muhammad's cousin and "Interpreter of the Qur'an," said: "Seven earths: In each earth is a prophet like your prophet, an Adam like Adam, a Noah like Noah, an Abraham like Abraham, a Jesus like Jesus" (Tabari, Tafsir on 65:12). This corresponds to ancient Babylonian and Greek cosmology – seven planetary spheres with seven "earths." Not continents, not climate zones, not crust layers.

Punchline: Seven earths. Each with its own Adam and Noah. Says Ibn Abbas.

BONUS DILEMMA #107: MEDIUM – No Brothers of Jesus in the Qur'an

Source A: New Testament, Mark 6:3 – "Is this not the carpenter, the son of Mary, the brother of James, Joses, Judas, and Simon? And are his sisters not here with us?" **Source B:** Qur'an – Not a single verse mentions siblings of Jesus.

Core of the Dilemma: The NT names four BROTHERS of Jesus by name (James, Joses, Judas, Simon) and mentions SISTERS. James became the LEADER of the Jerusalem church (Acts 15, Gal 2:9). His existence is multiply attested by Paul, Josephus, and the extra-biblical tradition. The Qur'an knows Mary as mother of Jesus – but mentions with NO WORD that she had other children. The Qur'anic Christology constructs an isolated Mary-Jesus constellation. Why?

⚡ **MUSLIM DEFENSE:** The Qur'an does not mention many details that are in the Bible. The absence of Jesus' brothers proves nothing.

🛡 **NEUTRALIZATION:** The absence is strategic: The Qur'anic Mariology has no concept of "Mary had other children." Mary is exclusively "Mother of Jesus." Had the Qur'an mentioned the Lord's brothers, it would have to explain: Were they also virgin-born? Why are they not prophets? The simplest explanation: Muhammad knew the NT only fragmentarily – from oral sources that did not mention the Lord's brothers. An omniscient God would have known them.

→ See also: #1 (Mary), #34 (Gospel)

Punchline: Mary had four more sons. The Qur'an knows nothing of them. Omniscient?

CONCLUSION

These 102 Dilemmas – expanded by 5 Bonus Dilemmas – are an invitation to intellectual honesty.

We have not worked with English translations, but with Arabic primary sources. We have not asserted, but demonstrated. We have not harmonized, but let tensions stand. We have not hated, but asked.

The 102 Dilemmas are not an attack on Muslims as people. They are a challenge to the theological system of Islam – to its claim of being the perfect, contradiction-free revelation dictated by Allah Himself.

Shabir Ally began this discourse with his 101 "Contradictions" in the Bible. We answer with 102 Dilemmas in the Qur'an – methodologically cleaner, more source-faithful, more linguistically competent.

The question to every Muslim reader is simple: If a book dictated by ONE author (Allah), in ONE language, within 23 years, through ONE prophet, exhibits such contradictions – can it then truly be the perfect Word of God?

We leave the answer to the reader.

The evidence is on the table. The rest is conscience.

SOURCES & REFERENCES (Complete Work)

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 - **Historical Sources:** Tacitus, Annals 15.44 | Josephus, Antiquities 18.3.3 | Syriac Chronicle of 640
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END – COMPLETE 107 DILEMMAS (102 + 5 BONUS)